

Multi-scale Walkability Measurement Framework :

Application to Market Activity Analysis

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(2022 - 2026) *Transportation Engineering and Transportation Planning*, Integrated Master's and Doctoral Program, University of Seoul

(2024 - 2024) *Transport Studies Unit*, Visiting Ph.D. student, University of Oxford

Journal papers (7 articles in SCIE & SSCI, 3 articles in SCOPUS, 2 articles in KCI)

1. **Jeong, I.**, Choi, M., Kwak, J., Ku, D., & Lee, S. (2023). A comprehensive walkability evaluation system for promoting environmental benefits. *Scientific reports*, 13(1), 16183. (SCIE, Q2)
2. **Jeong, I.**, Chang, J., Lee, Y., Kwak, J., Kim, S., & Lee, S. (2026). Network Based Approach of Mobility Hubs for Sustainable Urban Mobility Systems. *In Proceedings of the Institution of Civil Engineers-Transport (pp. 1-18). Emerald Publishing Limited. (SCIE, Q3)*
3. Yu, Y., Kim, J., Choi, M., **Jeong, I.**, Lee, S. (2025). Humanizing Transit Hubs: A GIS-based Approach to Boost Walkability in Gangnam. *Proceedings of the Institution of Civil Engineers: Municipal Engineer. (SCIE, Q4)*
4. Lee, Y., Bencekri, M., Kwak, J., **Jeong, I.**, Lee, S. (2025). Electrification Pathways Towards Transport Decarbonization with a Systematic Review. *Clean Technologies and Environmental Policy. (SCIE, Q2)*
5. Kim, S., **Jeong, I.**, Choi, M., Kwak, J., Bencekri, M., & Lee, S. (2024). Fractal dimensional analysis to reveal traffic flow dynamics as organic metabolism. *Transportmetrica A: Transport Science*, 2390009. (SSCI, Q3)
6. Kwak, J., **Jeong, I.**, Lee, D., Ku, D., & Lee, S. (2024, August). Lessons learned from spatiotemporal effect of COVID on the population density in the CBD. *Proceedings of the Institution of Civil Engineers: Municipal Engineer* (Vol. 177, No. 4, pp. 169-179). Emerald Publishing Limited. (SCIE, Q4)
7. Lee, Y., Lee, S., Jeong, I., Kwak, J., Kim, S., & Lee, S. (2025). Reinforcement Learning-Based Planning of Dedicated Autonomous Vehicle Lanes for Adaptive Infrastructure Design. *Proceedings of the Institution of Civil Engineers: Municipal Engineer. (SCIE, Q4)*
8. **Jeong, I.**, Choi, M., Ku, D., & Lee, S. (2022). Activation plans of public transport based on urban network analysis. *Chemical Engineering Transactions*, 97, 169-174. (SCOPUS)
9. Jo, J., Kim, G., Kwak, J., Jeong, I., Ku, D., & Lee, S. (2023). Air quality modeling using real-time Urban big data. *Chemical Engineering Transactions*, 106, 229-234. (SCOPUS)
10. Kwak, J., Oh, H., **Jeong, I.**, Shin, S., Ku, D., & Lee, S. (2021). Changes in shared bicycle usage by COVID-19. *Chemical Engineering Transactions*, 89, 169-174. (SCOPUS)
11. Park, J., Ku, D., **Jeong, I.**, & Lee, S. (2022). A study of walking activity time characteristics based on the time use survey. *Journal of the Korea Institute of Intelligent Transportation Systems*, 21(3), 53-61. (KCI)
12. Kwak, J., Ku, D., Oh, H., **Jeong, I.**, Shin, S., & Lee, S. (2022). Impact Analysis in Spatial Use Changes by COVID: Focusing on Shared Bicycles. *Journal of Korean Society of Transportation*, 40(2), 178-189. (KCI)

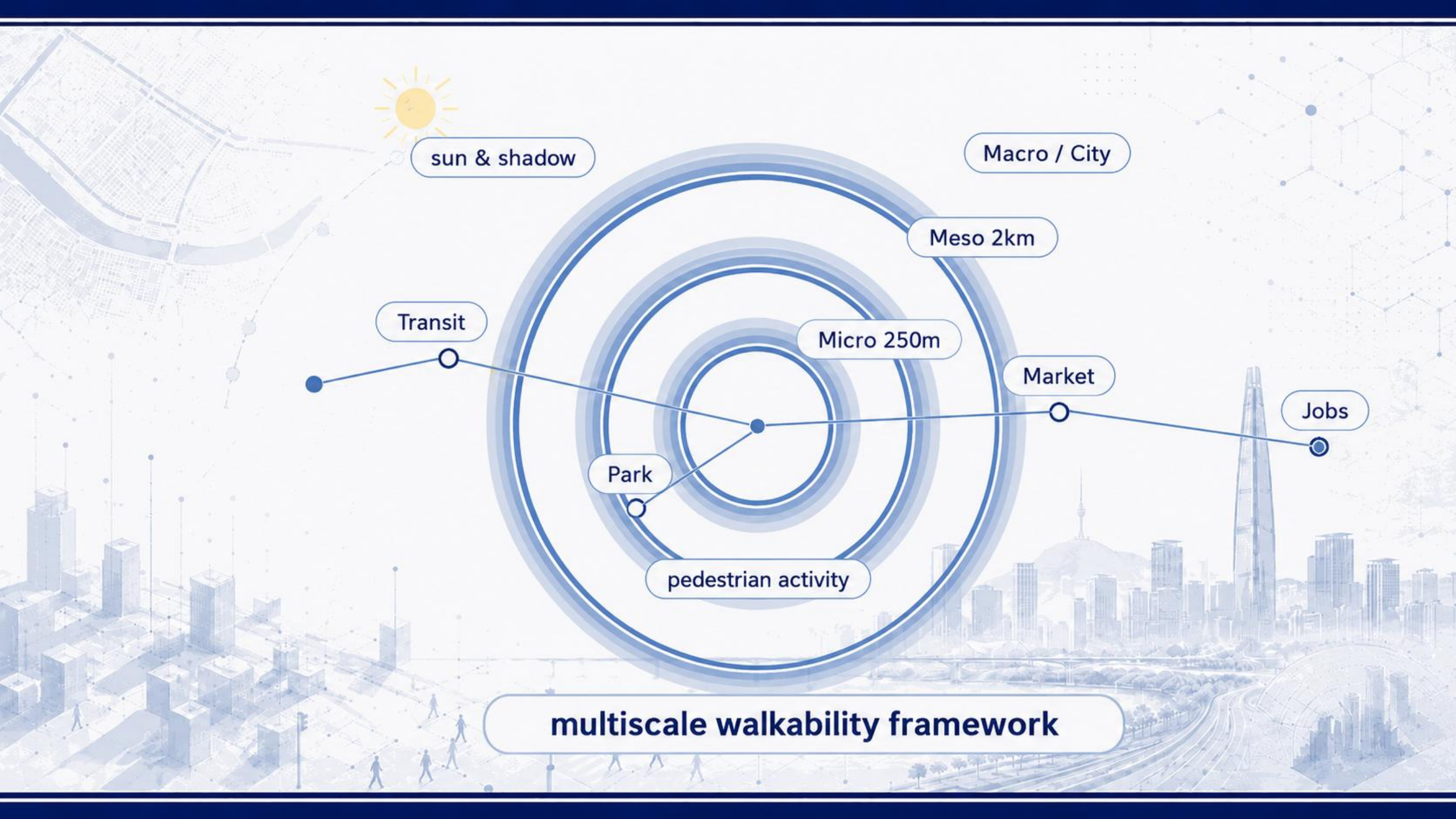
Research in progress

1. **Jeong, I.**, Park, S., Lee, Y., Kwak, J., Kim, S., & Lee, S. (2026). A Pedestrian-Aware, Energy-Efficient Pathfinding Framework for Autonomous Delivery Robots. *Transportation Research Record*.
2. Kim, S., **Jeong, I.**, ... , Lee, S. (2026). Prioritising Street Space Reallocation:A Spatial Framework for Urban Transport Planning. *International Journal of Urban Sciences*.
3. **Jeong, I.**, ... , Lee, S. (2026). Urban Walkability and Mental Health:A Global Meta-analysis of Evidence across Cities. *Nature communications*.

Urban Resilience Weaknesses

and the Role of the Urban Resilience Framework





multiscale walkability framework

1. Motivation

- I. Walkable cities
- II. What makes a city walkable?
- III. Emerging challenges for walkability
- IV. Benefits of Walkability



01

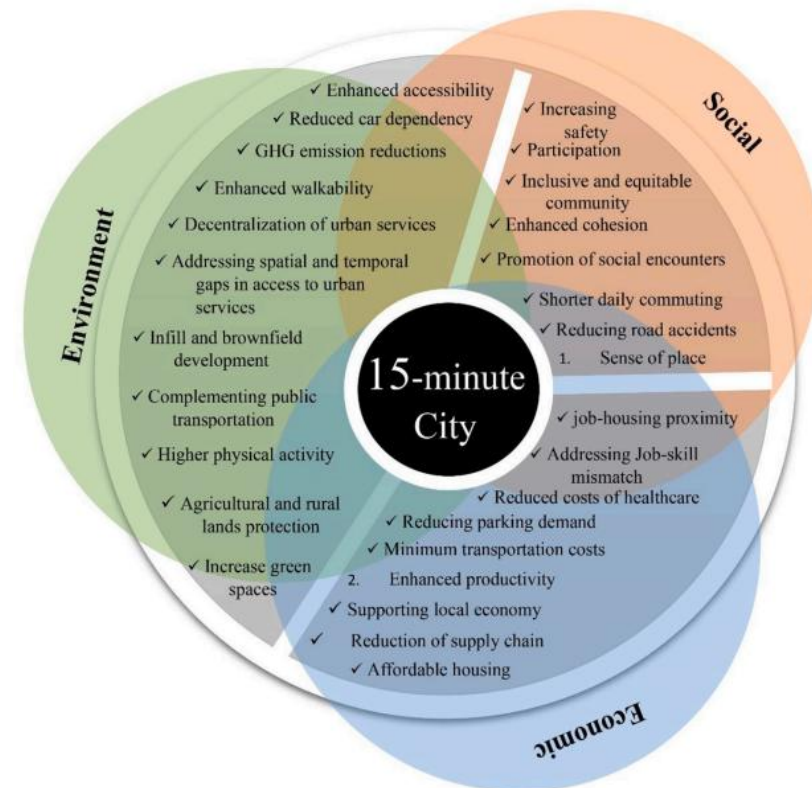
Motivation : Walkable cities

- Many cities are promoting walkable urban environments as part of their urban and mobility planning.
- Their benefits extend beyond walking itself, contributing to environmental, social, and economic sustainability.

Walkable urban environment



Walkable cities to urban sustainability



01 Motivation : What makes a city walkable?

- Walkability is shaped by multiple factors operating at different spatial scales.

What makes a city walkable?



01

Motivation : Emerging challenges for walkability

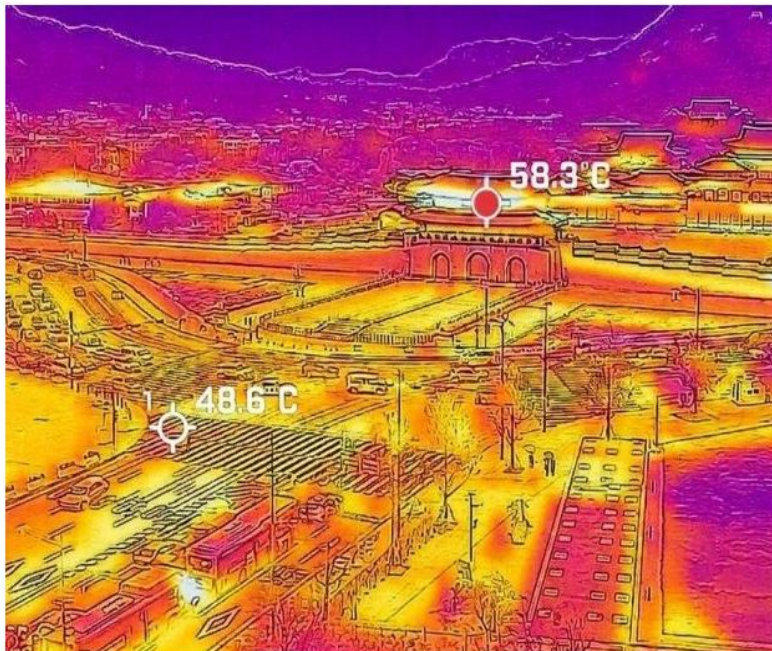
- Climate change is making thermal comfort an increasingly important walking condition.

Extreme Heat in Seoul

Seoul issues highest heat alert amid extreme temperatures

Posted August. 05, 2026 08:49, Updated August. 05, 2026 08:49

한국어 f X



Headline News

Extreme heat pushes Seoul to 40 degrees

Lee orders all-out climate disaster response

Industry minister calls for work-hour reform

Pentagon considers tactical nuclear strategy shift

Kim Dae-won scores memorable goal against Man City



Shade-Seeking Behavior under Extreme Heat



01

Motivation : Benefits of Walkability

- **Walkable environments can reduce transport externalities while providing measurable health and economic benefits.**
- **Walkability can also create wider economic value through local business activity, property values, investment, and urban efficiency.**

Health and Economic Benefits of Walking and Walkability



World Health Organization
EUROPE



Economic Value of Walkability
16 December 2024

By
Todd Litman
Victoria Transport Policy Institute

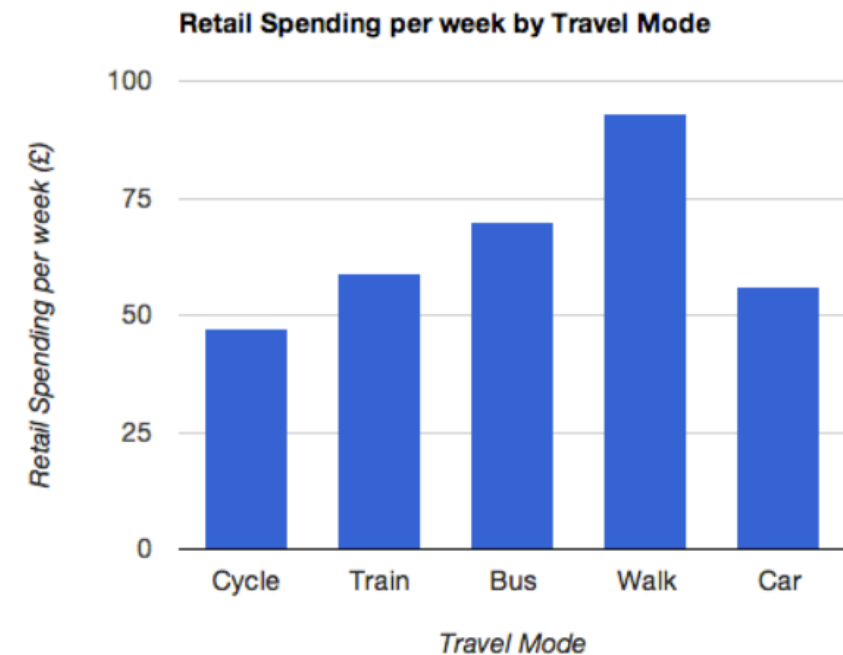


Health economic assessment tool (HEAT) for walking and for cycling

Methods and user guide on physical activity, air pollution, injuries and carbon impact assessments

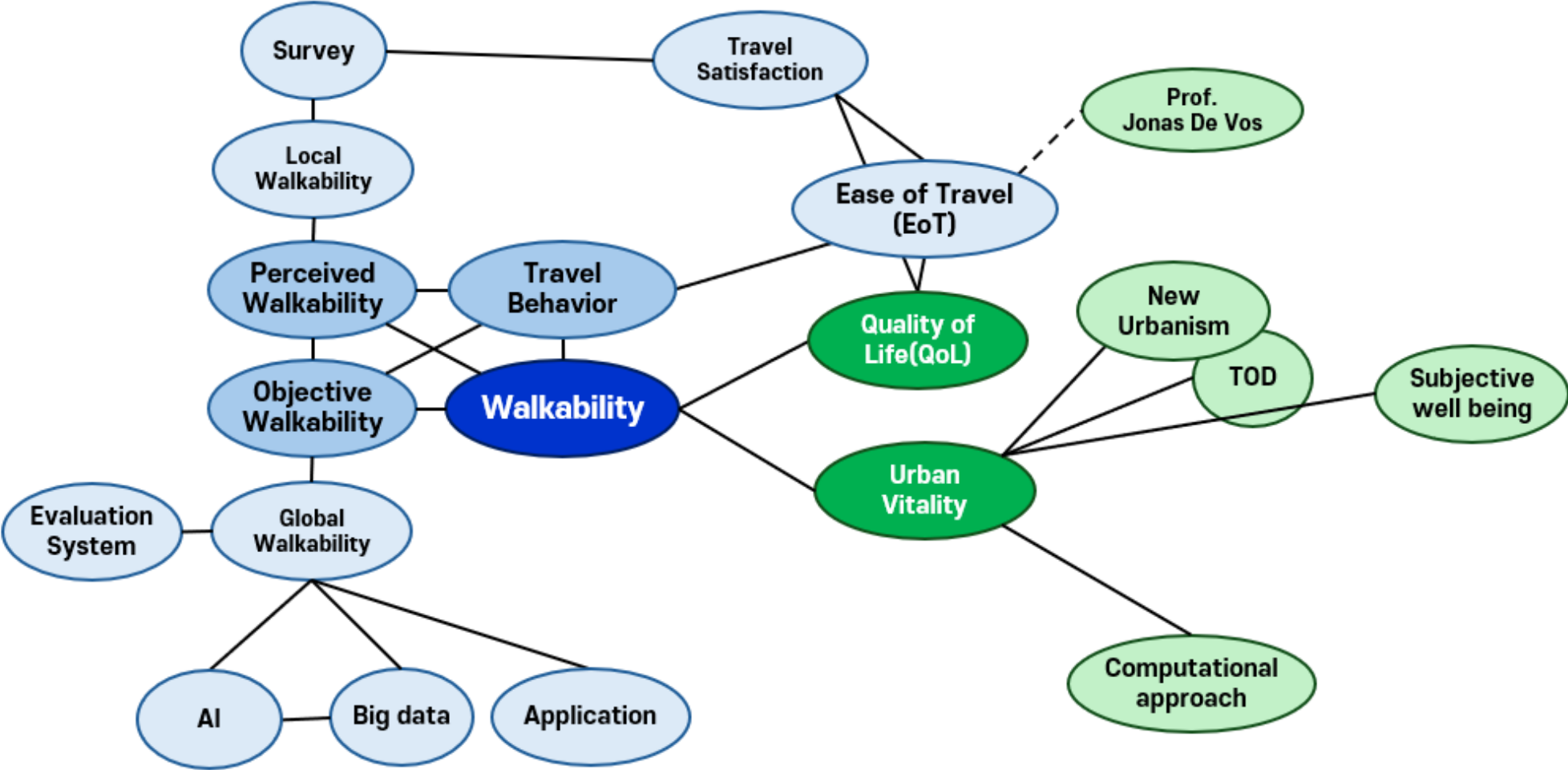


Retail Spending by Travel Mode

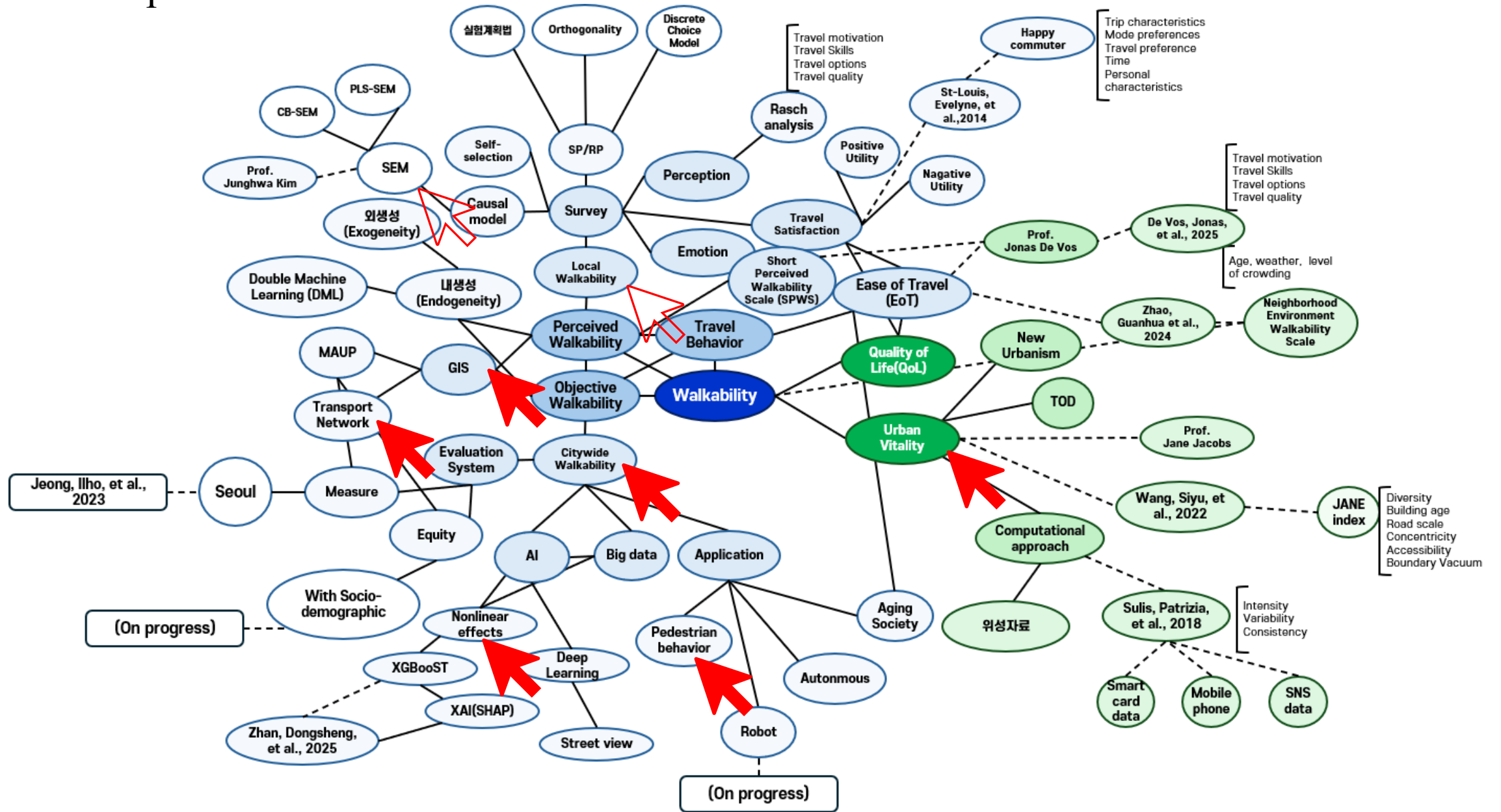


S: <https://retail-insider.com/retail-insider>

Research map



Research map



01

Research Gaps and Contributions

- **Research Gaps**

- 1) Walkability is shaped by spatially and temporally varying conditions that cannot be fully captured by a single, fixed indicator.
- 2) The effects of walkability on actual walking behavior may differ across spatial scales.
- 3) The influence of walkability may extend beyond walking behavior to broader urban outcomes, including commercial activity.

- **Research Contributions**



2. Research Design

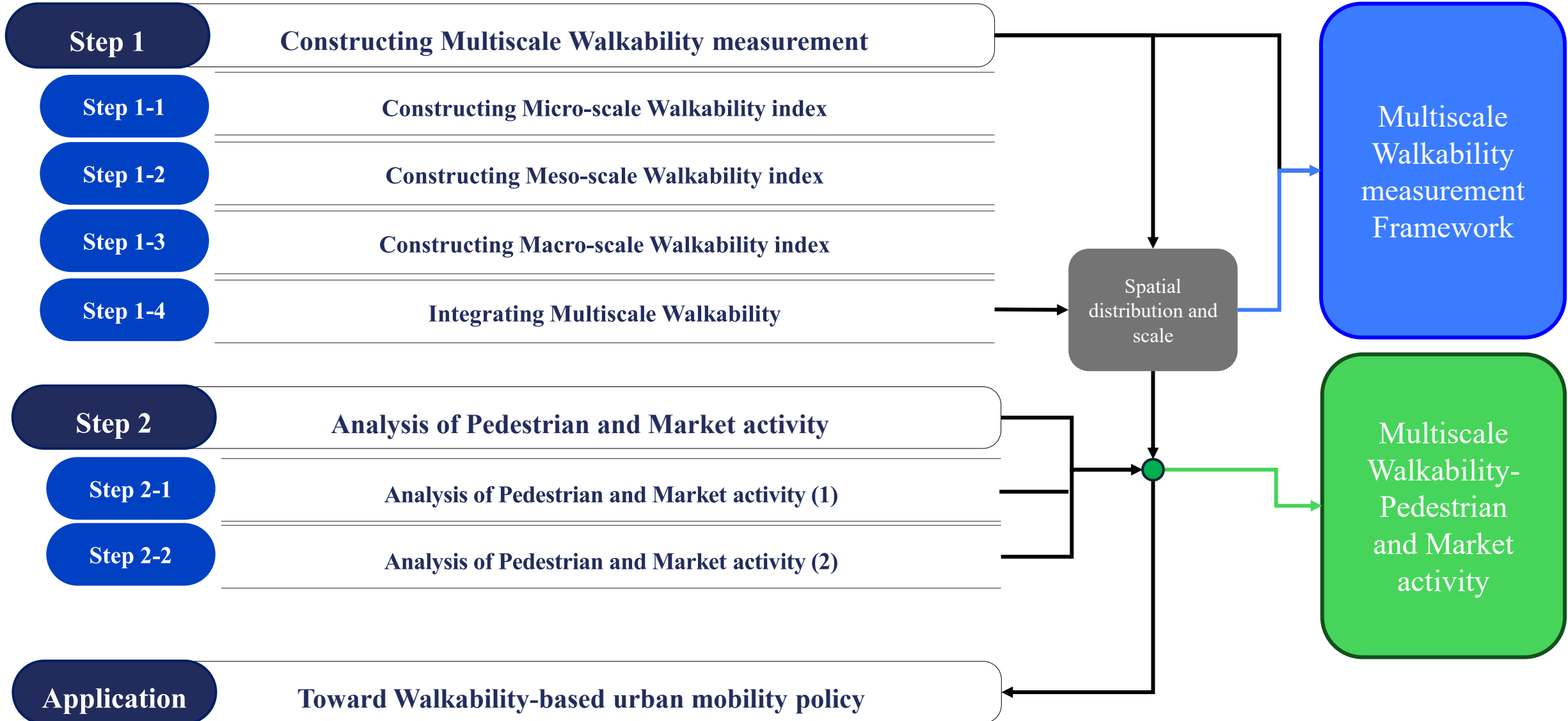
I. Research Framework

II. Literature Review and Research Gap



02

Research Framework



Literature Review



1. Walkability components

- Density, land-use mix, street connectivity, accessibility, and transit access.



2. Walking distance and exposure range

- Thresholds range from about 150 m to over 2 km, depending on purpose and context.



3. Scale-specific indicators

- Indicators have been developed separately for city/block, network, and street scales.



4. Seasonal and thermal conditions

- Shade and thermal comfort affect route choice and walking experience.



5. Walkability and commercial activity

- Walkability is linked to retail or business performance, usually at limited scales.



Research Gaps

01

Limited multiscale perspective

Existing studies often examine walkability at a single spatial scale, with limited attention to how its effects differ across street-, neighborhood-, and city-scale conditions.

02

Limited consideration of behavioral range and temporal conditions

Walking distance, exposure range, and seasonal thermal conditions are often treated separately, despite their combined influence on actual walking behavior.

03

Limited evidence on downstream urban outcomes

How multiscale walkability translates into pedestrian activity and subsequently into commercial activity remains insufficiently understood.

3. Methodology

- I. Multiscale Walkability Measurement**
- II. Study Scope and Data**

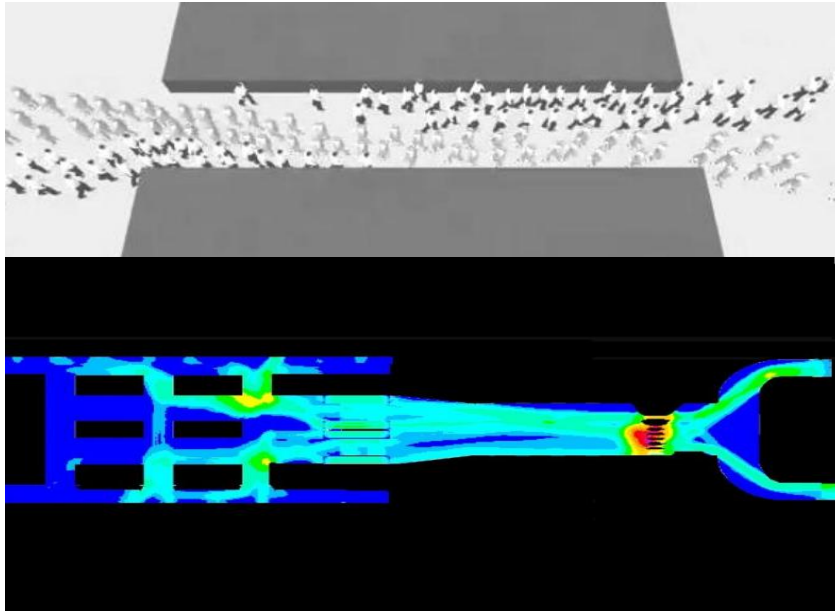


03

Multiscale Walkability(1): Defining the Micro-Scale Walkability Index

- Conventional transportation studies have mainly evaluated walking through **pedestrian flow and service levels, with limited consideration of spatial context.**
- This study defines micro-scale walkability as **local physical and network conditions** within a 250 m grid.

Examples of conventional pedestrian evaluation (Viswalk)



Micro-scale walkability index

$$W_{micro} = Z(\ln(SW + 1)) - Z(\ln(SL + 1)) + Z(\ln(CW + 1))$$

W_{micro} = micro-scale walkability

SW = sidewalk length within the grid

SL = average slope within the grid

CW = number of crosswalks within the grid

→ The logarithmic form : potential nonlinear effects of infrastructure supply.

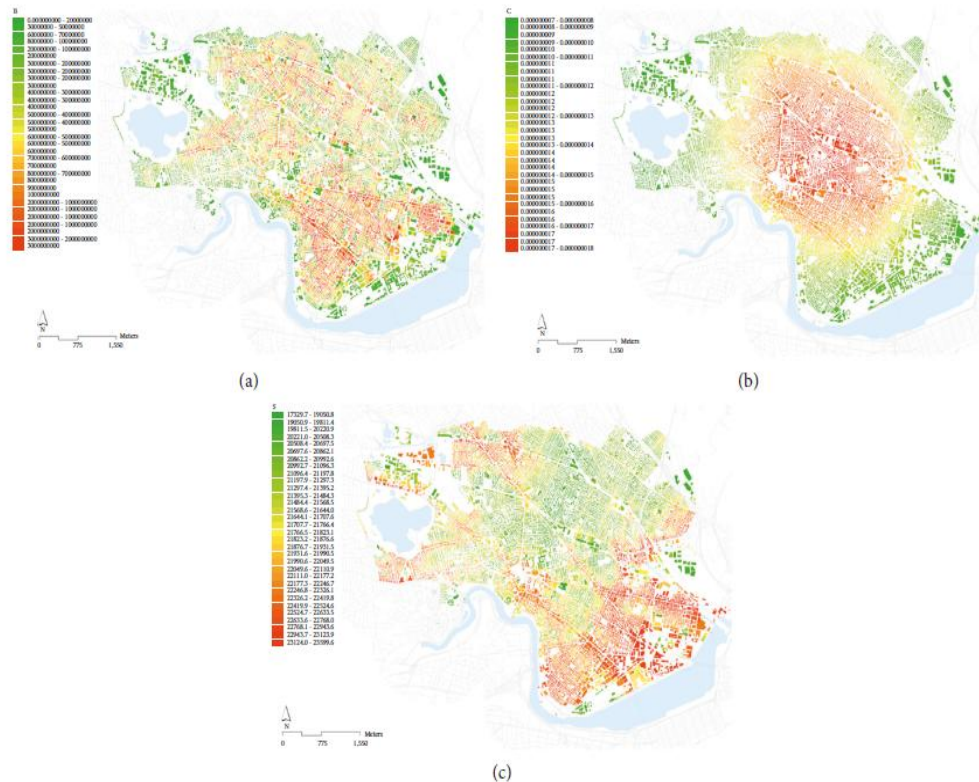
→ Each indicator is standardized using Z-scores to ensure comparability.

03

Multiscale Walkability(2): Defining the Meso-Scale Walkability Index

- In this study, meso-scale walkability quantifies relative accessibility to public transport stations using [Urban Network Analysis \(UNA\)](#), capturing factors that influence pedestrian route choice.
- It also incorporates [seasonal comfort by considering sun shadow frequency](#) as a factor that can encourage or discourage walking.

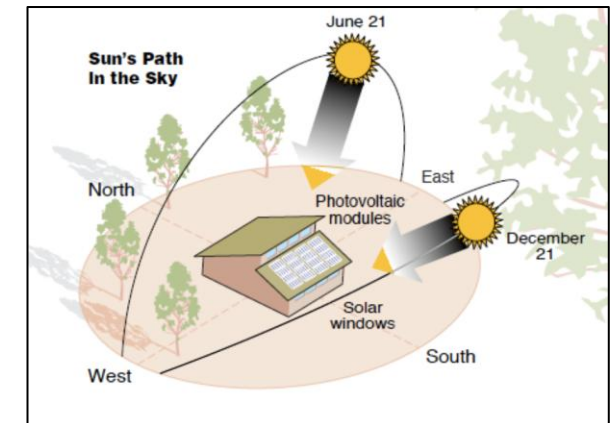
UNA-Based Network Accessibility Analysis



Solar Shadow Frequency Analysis

Shadow length varies with [seasonal solar altitude \(\$\alpha\$ \)](#), considering latitude, longitude, date, and time.

Shadow length is calculated based on [3D building height \(H\)](#), and accumulated over time to estimate [shadow exposure \(\$ST_i\$ \)](#).



$$L_{shadow} = \frac{H}{\tan(\alpha)}$$

$$ST_i = \sum_{t=1}^T S_i(t) \cdot \Delta t$$

$$S_i(t) = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if shaded} \\ 0 & \text{if sunlight} \end{cases}$$

03

Multiscale Walkability(2): Defining the Meso-Scale Walkability Index

- **Meso-scale walkability links the micro scale (local physical conditions) with the macro scale (urban structure), focusing on route choice and connectivity within the pedestrian network.**
- **It represents walking-related opportunities and constraints within a 2 km range, including access to destinations, public transport accessibility, seasonal comfort, and development density (FAR).**

Components of Meso-Scale Walkability

- | | |
|---|--|
| • Destination accessibility | Average network distance to major POIs |
| • Public transport accessibility | Accessibility to bike, bus, and subway stations |
| • Seasonal comfort | Average seasonal shadow frequency |
| • Development density (FAR) | Average floor area ratio |

Meso-Scale Walkability Index

$$W_{meso} = Z(\ln(A + 1)) + Z(\ln(Bet * PT + 1)) + Z(\ln(SS + 1)) + Z(\ln(FAR + 1))$$

W_{meso} = meso-scale walkability

A =number of major destinations (POIs)

Bet =network centrality (betweenness)

PT =public transport station accessibility

SS =seasonal shadow frequency along sidewalks

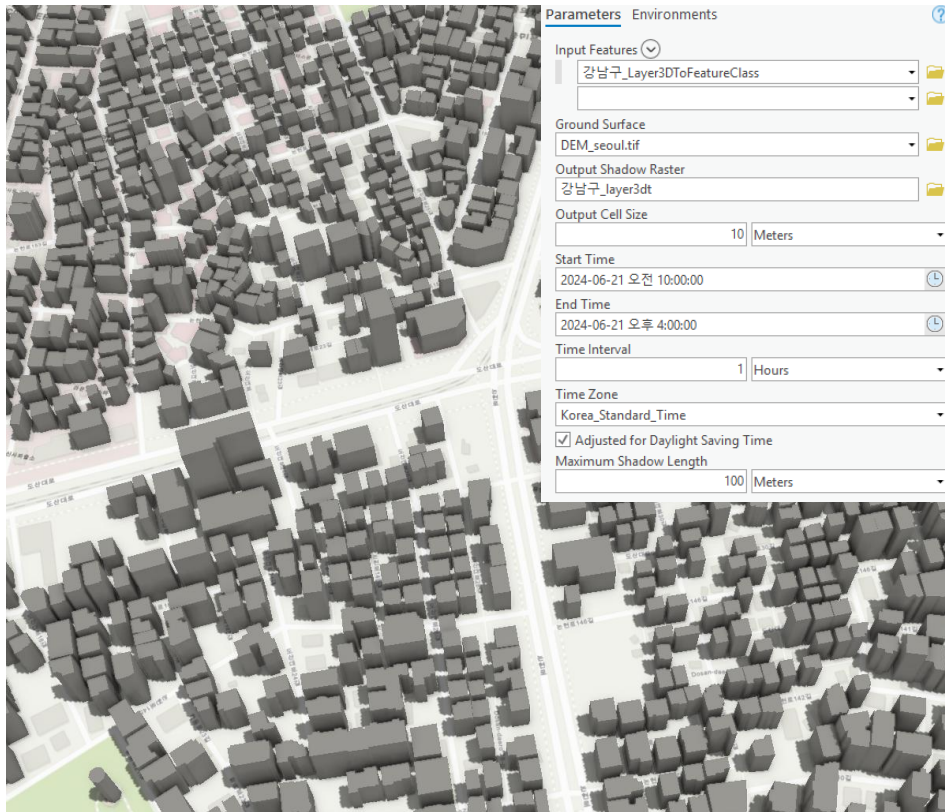
FAR =average floor area ratio

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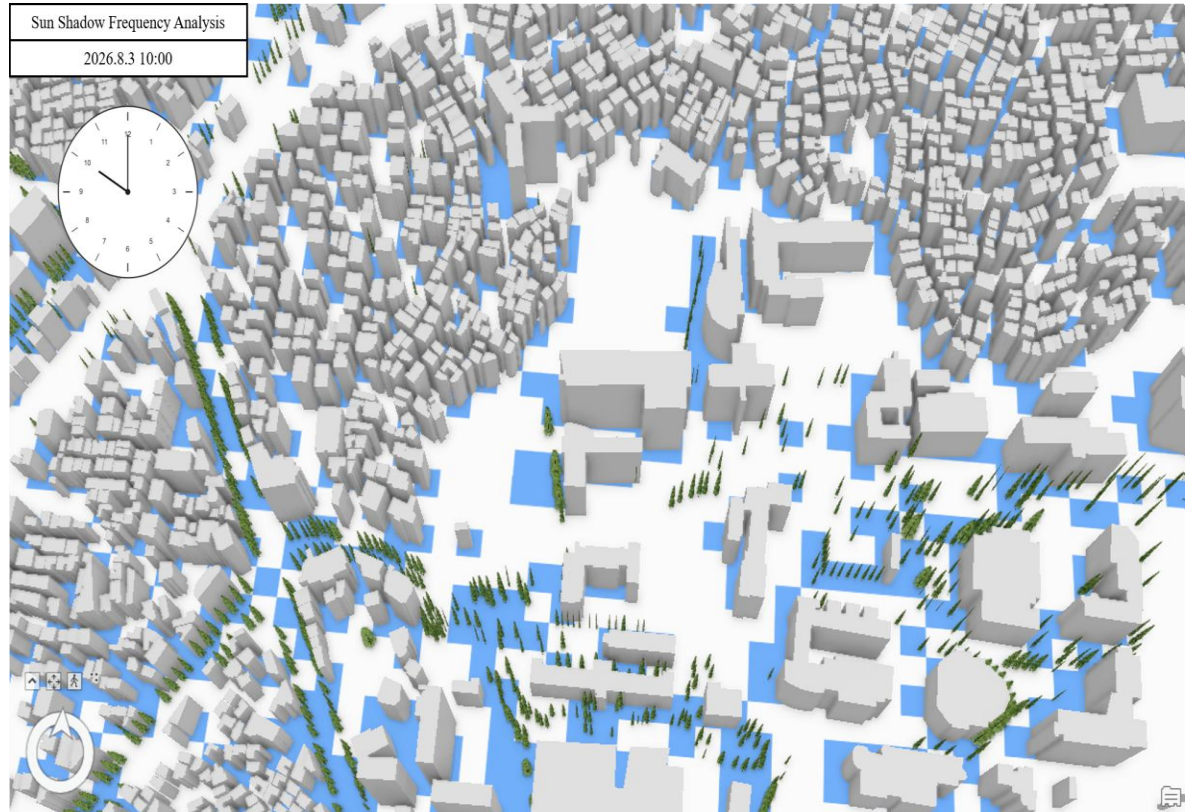
Meso-Scale Walkability Index : Sun Shadow Frequency Analysis

- Sun shadow frequency was analyzed using 3D building and tree models, with **date, time range, interval, and cell size** specified as key parameters.
- Seasonal analyses were conducted for **Spring/Fall, Summer, and Winter** to capture temporal variation in walkability.

3D Building and Tree Modelling

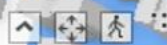
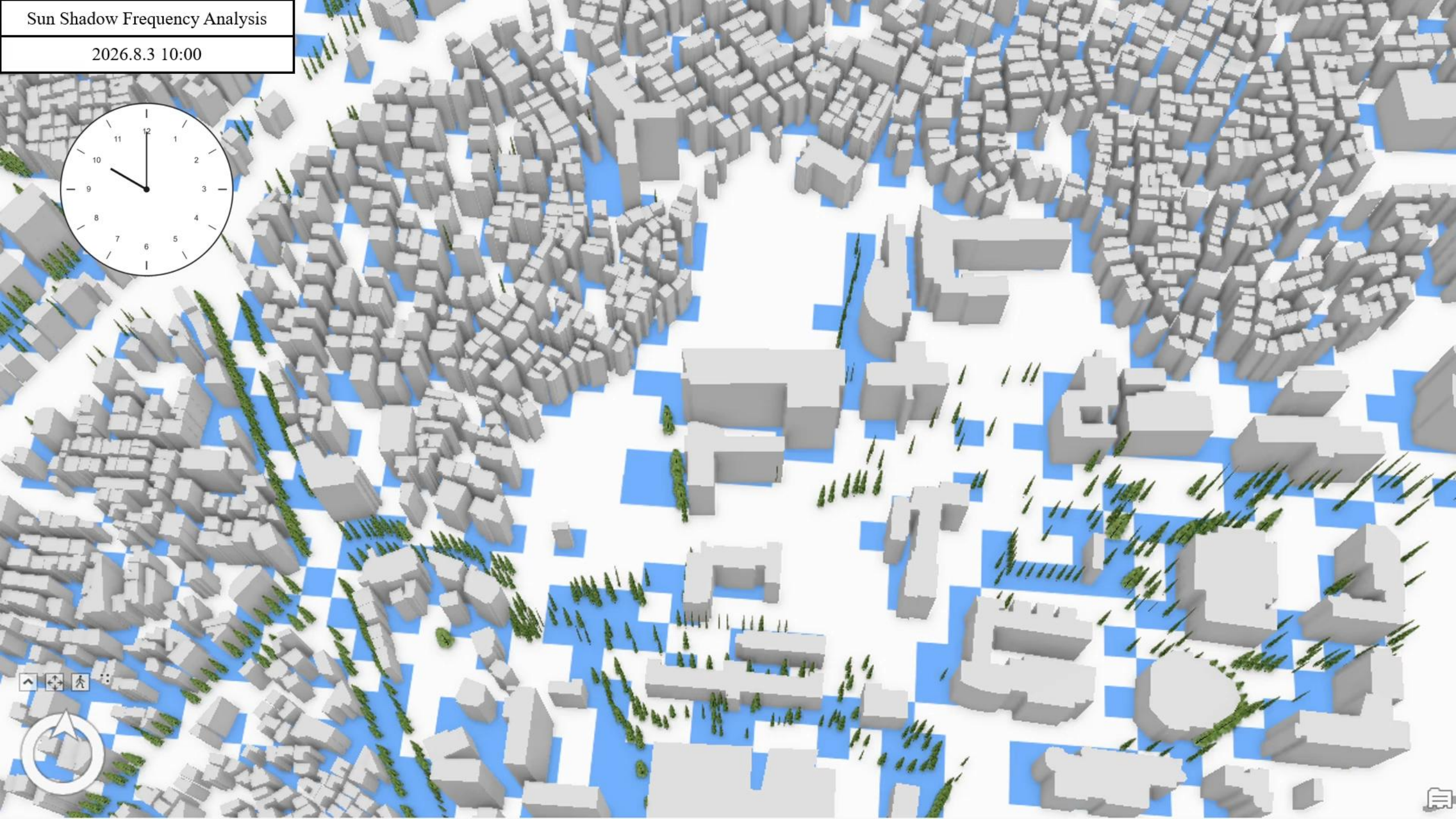


Sun Shadow Frequency Analysis example (26.8.3)



Sun Shadow Frequency Analysis

2026.8.3 10:00



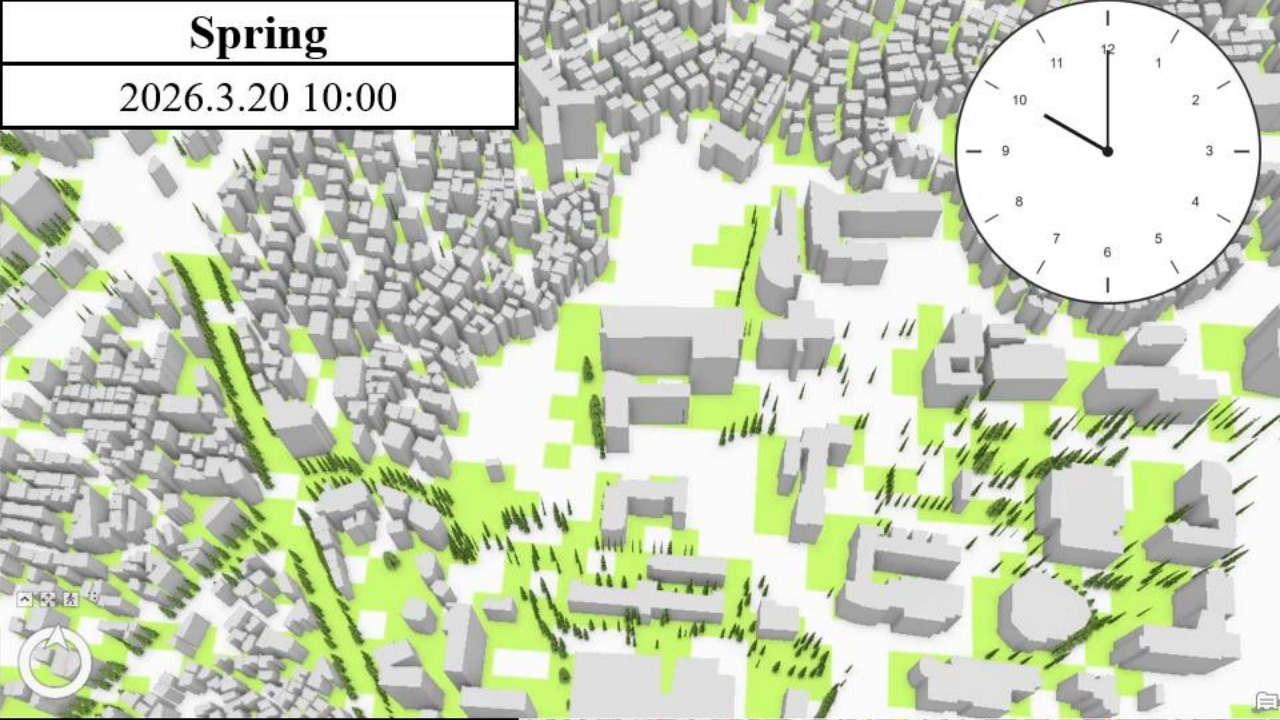
Winter

2025.12.22 10:00



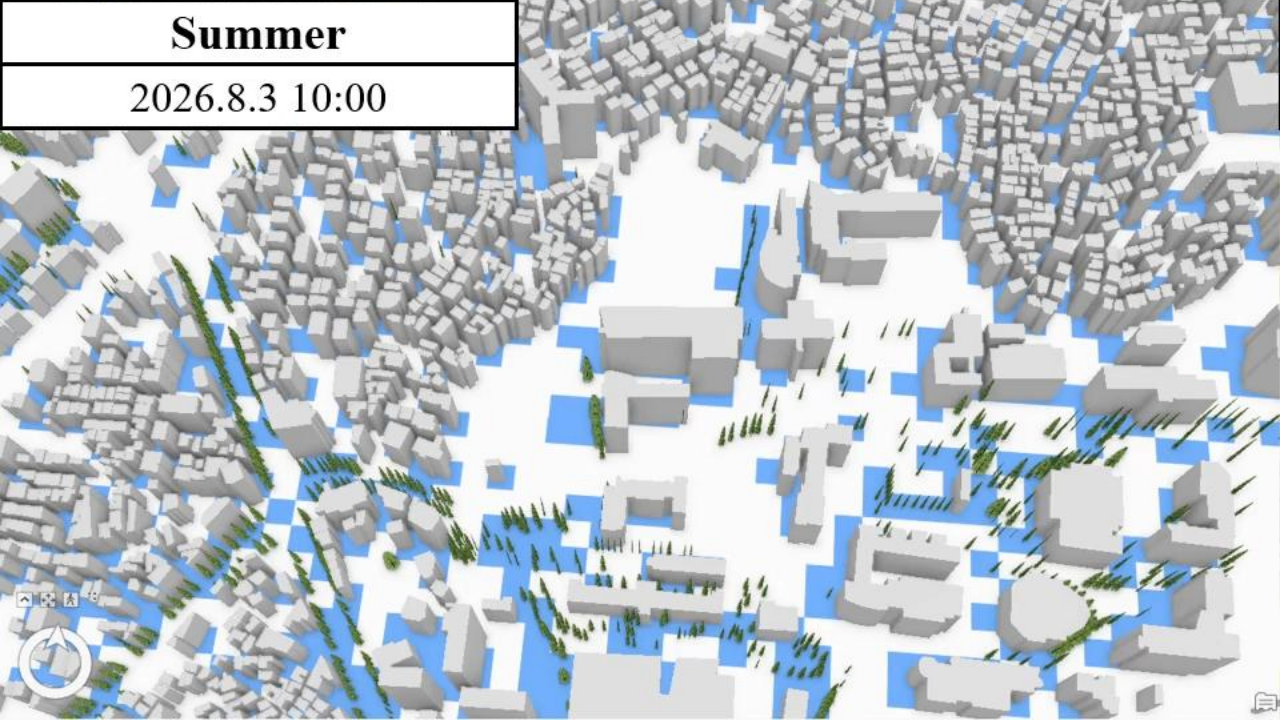
Spring

2026.3.20 10:00



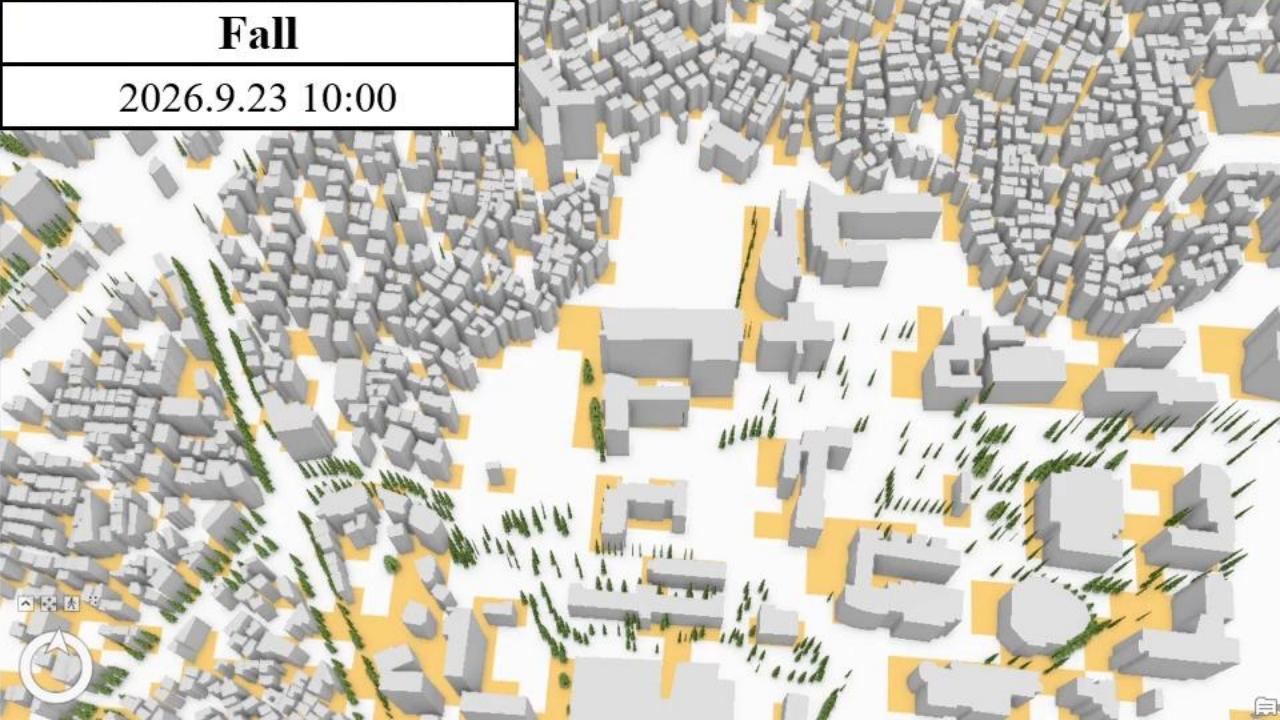
Summer

2026.8.3 10:00



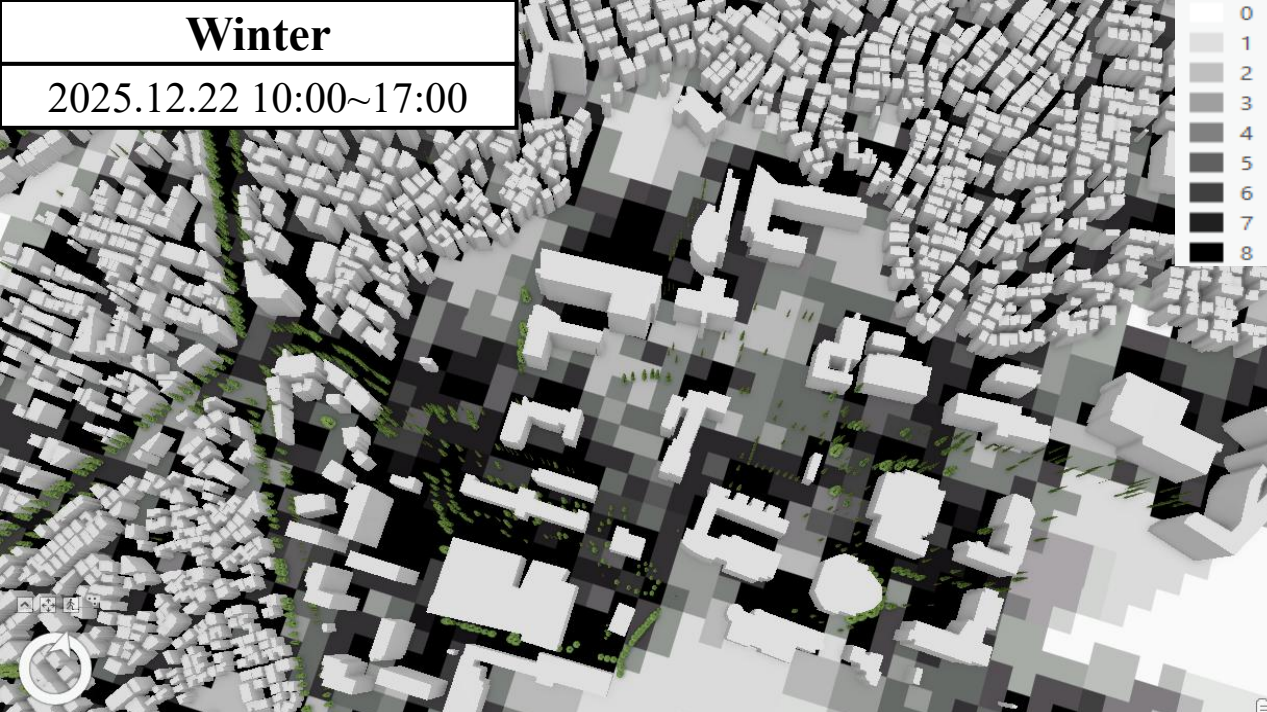
Fall

2026.9.23 10:00



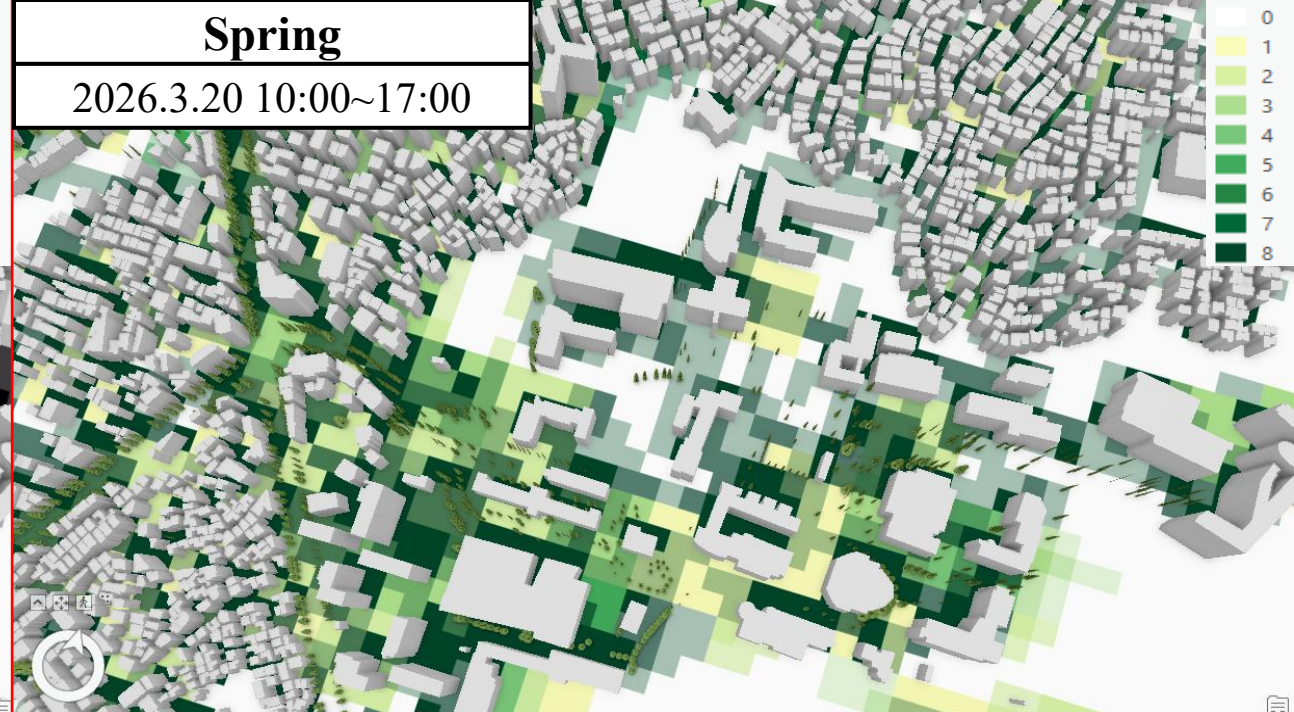
Winter

2025.12.22 10:00~17:00



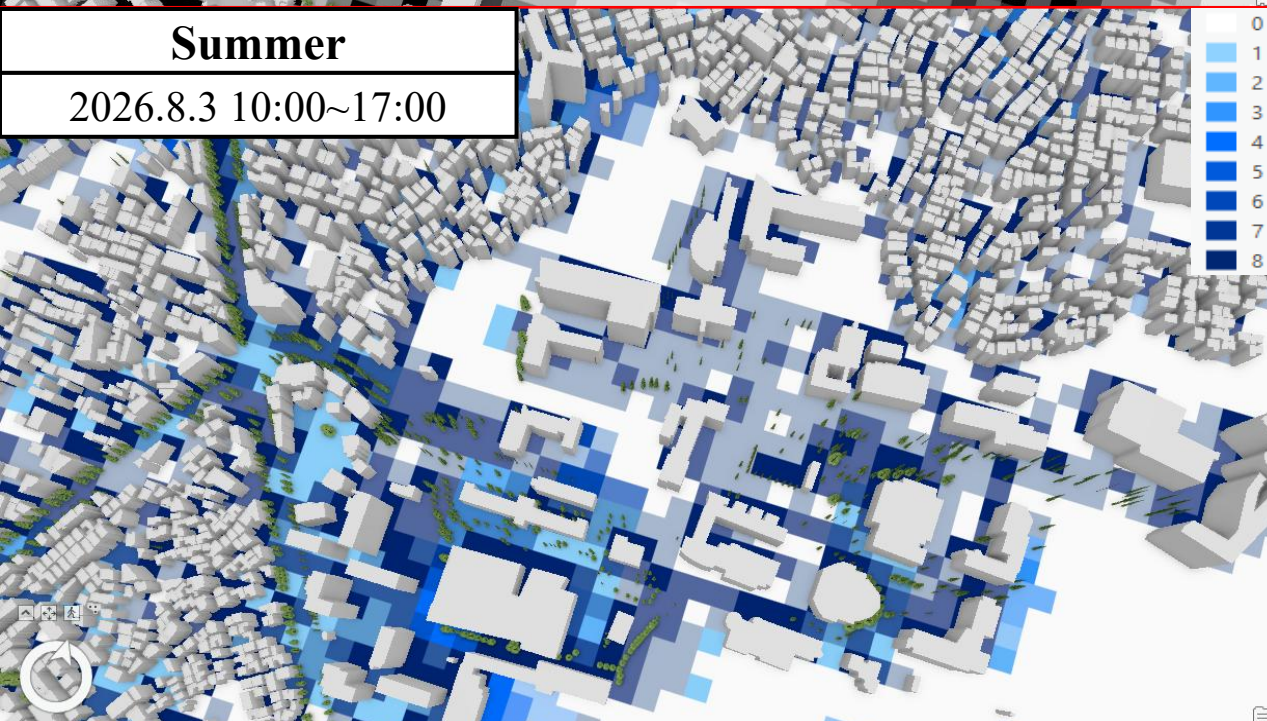
Spring

2026.3.20 10:00~17:00



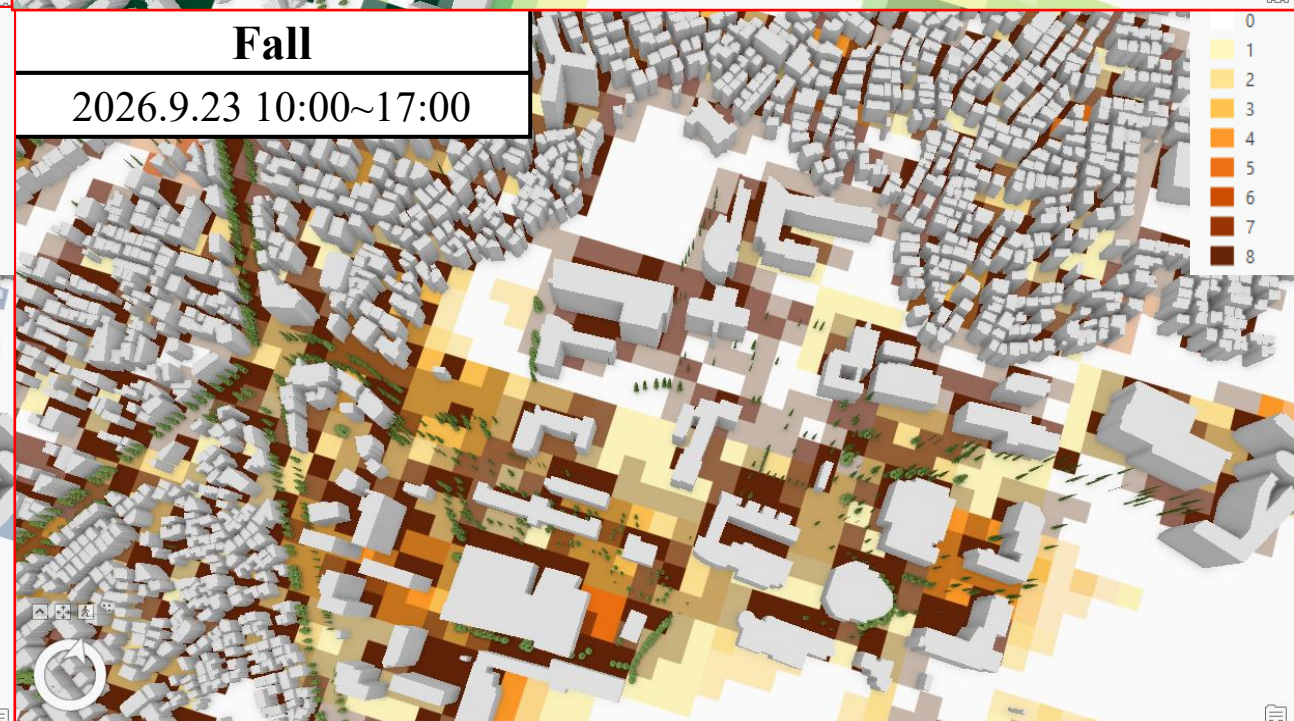
Summer

2026.8.3 10:00~17:00



Fall

2026.9.23 10:00~17:00



03

Multiscale Walkability(3): Defining the Macro-Scale Walkability Index

- Macro-scale walkability extends beyond local pedestrian environments to capture the structural walking potential and locational attractiveness of each area within the citywide transport network.
- It is constructed using land-use mix, jobs–housing balance, and the relative travel cost of public transport versus private cars.

Components of Macro-Scale Walkability

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|--|
| • Land-use mix | Entropy index of surrounding administrative areas |
| • Jobs–housing balance | Ratio of workers to residents in surrounding areas |
| • Public transport efficiency | Public transport travel cost / car travel cost |

Macro-Scale Walkability Index

$$W_{macro} = Z \left(\ln \left(\sum_{j \neq i} \left[\frac{(L_j + JHR_j)}{Cost_{i,j}^{PT} / Cost_{i,j}^{Auto}} \times \left(\frac{V_{i,j}}{\sum_k V_{i,k}} \right) \right] + 1 \right) \right)$$

W_{macro} = macro-scale walkability

L_j = land-use mix at destination j

JHR_j = jobs–housing ratio at destination j

$Cost_{i,j}^{PT}$ = public transport travel cost

$Cost_{i,j}^{Auto}$ = private car travel cost

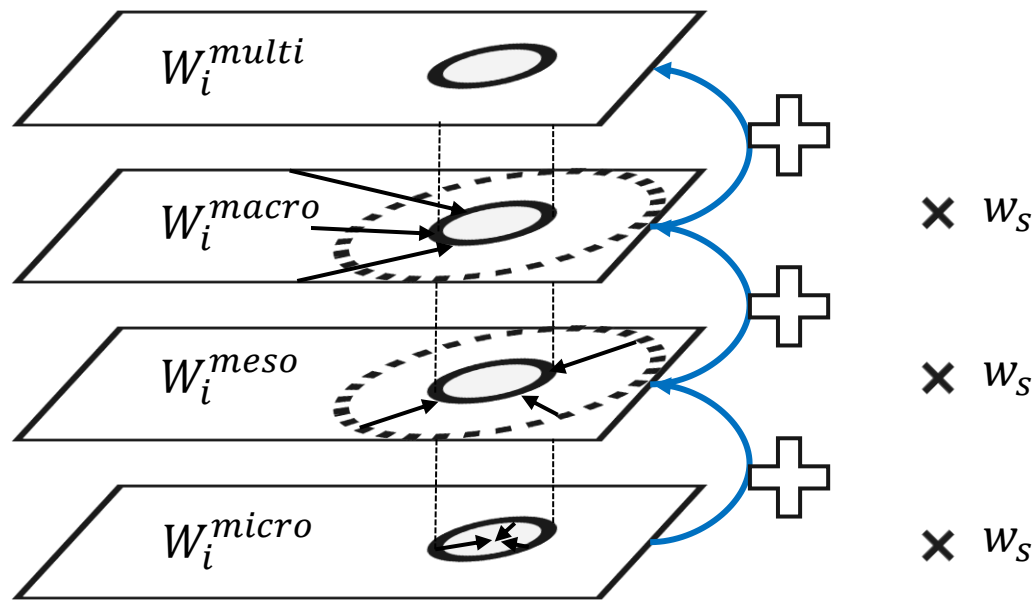
$V_{i,j}$ = public transport travel volume

03

Multiscale Walkability(4): Integrating Multiscale Walkability

- This study conceptualizes the walking environment across three spatial scales and integrates them by reflecting the functional role and spatial hierarchy of each scale.
- Both **equal weighting** and **data-driven weighting** are applied to compare alternative structures of multiscale walkability.

Integration of Multiscale Walkability



Multiscale Walkability Integration: Data-Driven Weighting

$$X_i = (W_i^{micro}, W_i^{meso}, W_i^{macro})$$

$$p_{i,s} = \frac{W_i^s}{\sum_{i=1}^n W_i^s}, \quad e_s = -\frac{1}{\ln n} \sum_{i=1}^n p_{i,s} \ln(p_{i,s})$$

$$w_s = -\frac{1 - e_s}{\sum_{s \in \{micro, meso, macro\}} (1 - e_s)}$$

$$W_i^{multiscale} = \sum_{s \in \{micro, meso, macro\}} \textcircled{w_s} W_i^s$$

W_i^s = walkability of location i at scale s

$p_{i,s}$ = relative share of location i within scale s

e_s = entropy of scale s (distributional uniformity)

$W_i^{multiscale}$ = multiscale walkability of location i

w_s = entropy-based weight for scale s

03 Research Scope and Data Used

- The temporal scope is **2024**, and the spatial scope is **Seoul**. The main datasets used in this study are summarized below.

Category	Data	Description	Source
Micro-Scale Walkability	Pedestrian network	• Physical conditions of the pedestrian network, such as length and location	• Seoul Open Data Plaza
	Elevation data	• Elevation at each point, used to calculate slope	• VWorld
	Crosswalks	• Crosswalk locations	• Seoul Open Data Plaza
	Floating population	• Used to estimate pedestrian LOS at specific locations based on Seoul urban data	• Seoul Open Data Plaza
Meso-Scale Walkability	POI data	• National Point of Interest information	• National Spatial Data Infrastructure Portal
	Bus stops	• Bus stop locations	• Seoul Open Data Plaza
	Subway stations	• Subway station locations	• Seoul Open Data Plaza
	Public bike stations	• Ttareungi bike-sharing station locations	• Seoul Open Data Plaza
	Seoul building data	• Building data in Seoul; floor information used for 3D modelling and sun shadow frequency analysis	• VWorld
Macro-Scale Walkability	Land use	• Entropy index calculated from land-use data	• Seoul Open Data Plaza
	Workers and residents	• Number of workers and residents by administrative dong	• Seoul Commercial District Analysis Service
	Transport network	• Road and public transport networks	• KTDB
	Mode O/D	• Passenger-car and public transport trip volumes	• KTDB
Estimated Pedestrian Volume	De facto population data	• Real-time population based on KT mobile communication data	• KT Telecom Data
	Daily mobility data	• Mobility data at the 250 m grid level based on KT mobile communication data	• KT Telecom Data
Walking Satisfaction	Walking satisfaction survey	• Seoul Survey responses related to walking satisfaction	• Seoul Survey
Commercial Area Analysis	Sales and transaction data	• Estimated store-level sales within Seoul commercial areas	• Seoul Credit Guarantee Foundation

4. Results

I. Construction of Multiscale Walkability

II. Market Activity Analysis Results

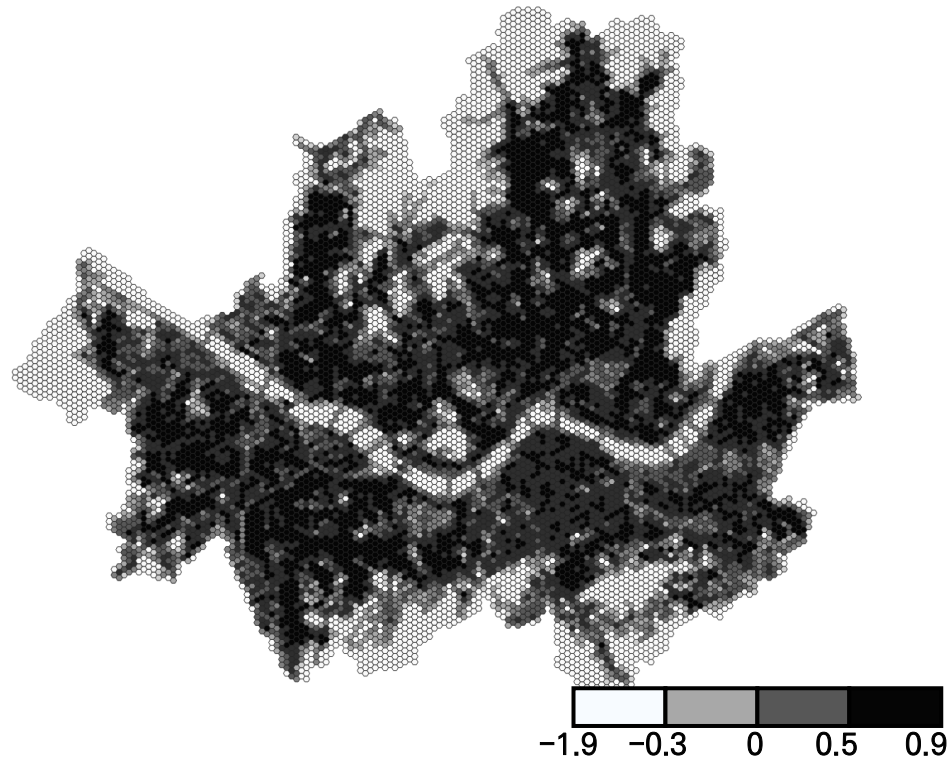


04

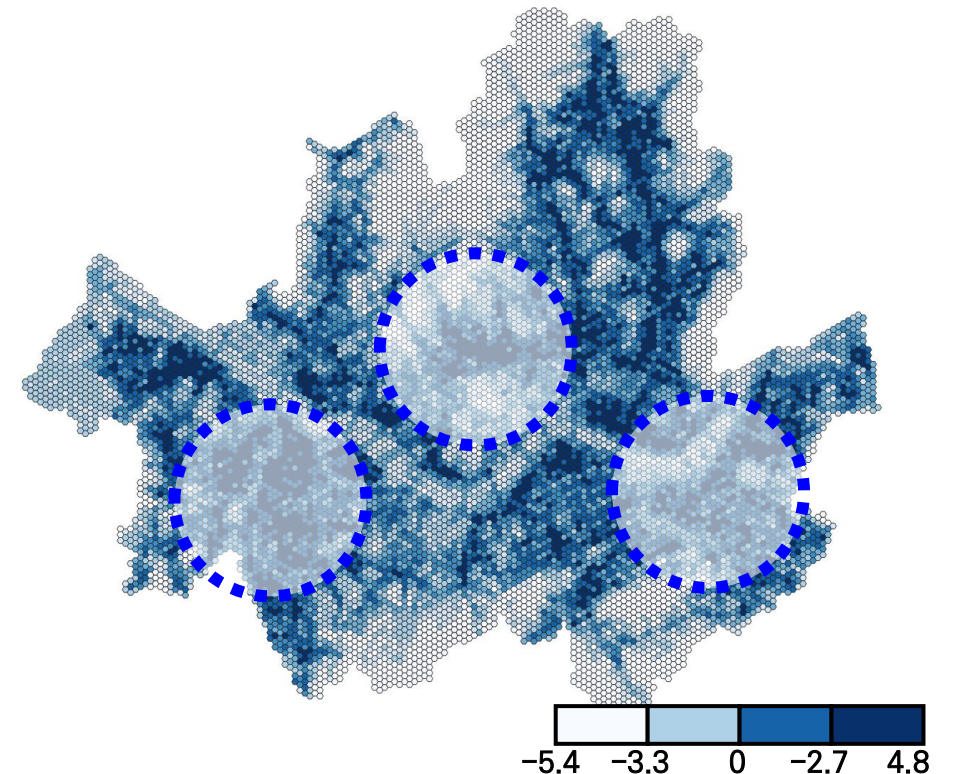
Construction of Multiscale Walkability (1): Micro-Scale Walkability index

- Pedestrian network supply is concentrated in several **central areas of Seoul**.
- Micro-scale walkability shows a more **spatially fragmented pattern**, reflecting the combined effects of sidewalk supply, slope, and crosswalk connectivity.

Distribution of Pedestrian Network Supply (Seoul)



Distribution of Micro-Scale Walkability (Seoul)

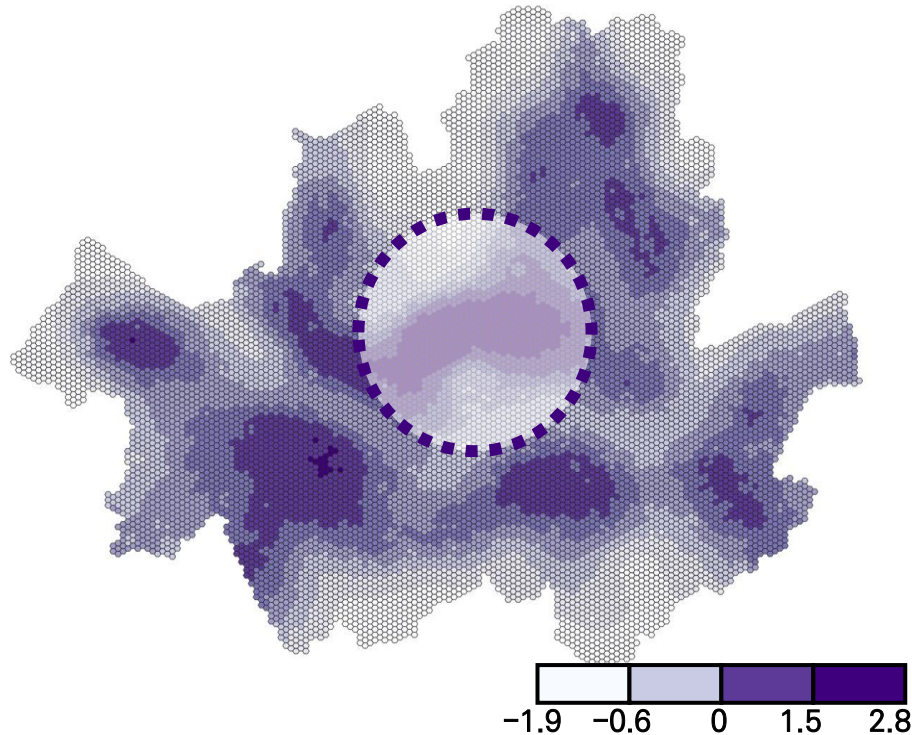


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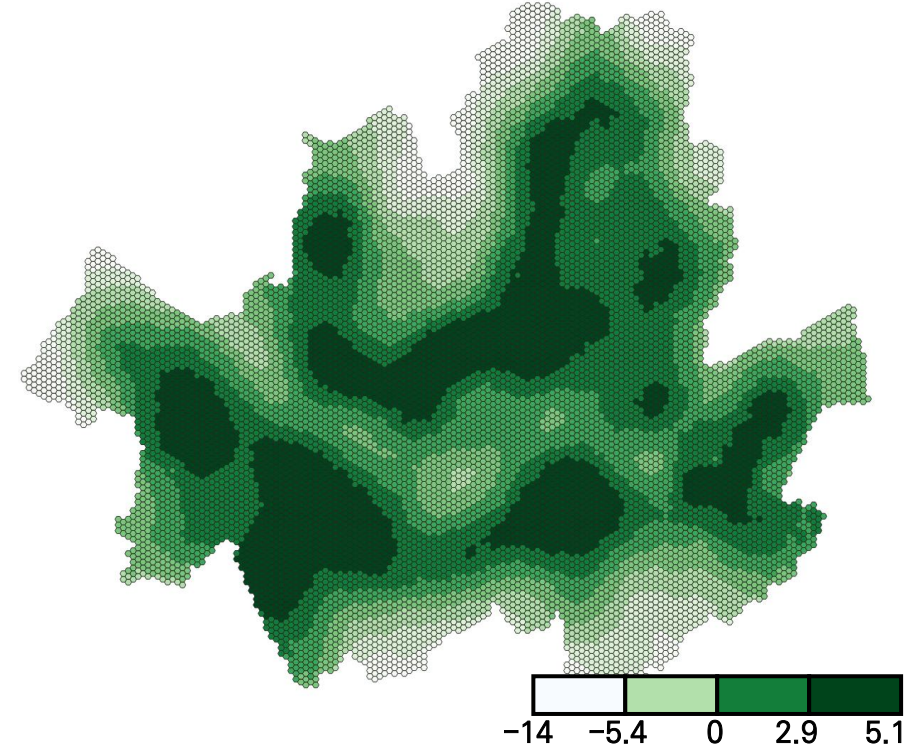
Construction of Multiscale Walkability (2): Meso-Scale Walkability index

- Meso-scale walkability captures network accessibility within a 2 km range.
- It connects micro- and macro-scale walkability through destinations, public transport, density, and seasonal comfort.

Public Transport Accessibility Weighted by Network Centrality :



Distribution of Meso-Scale Walkability (Seoul, Summer)

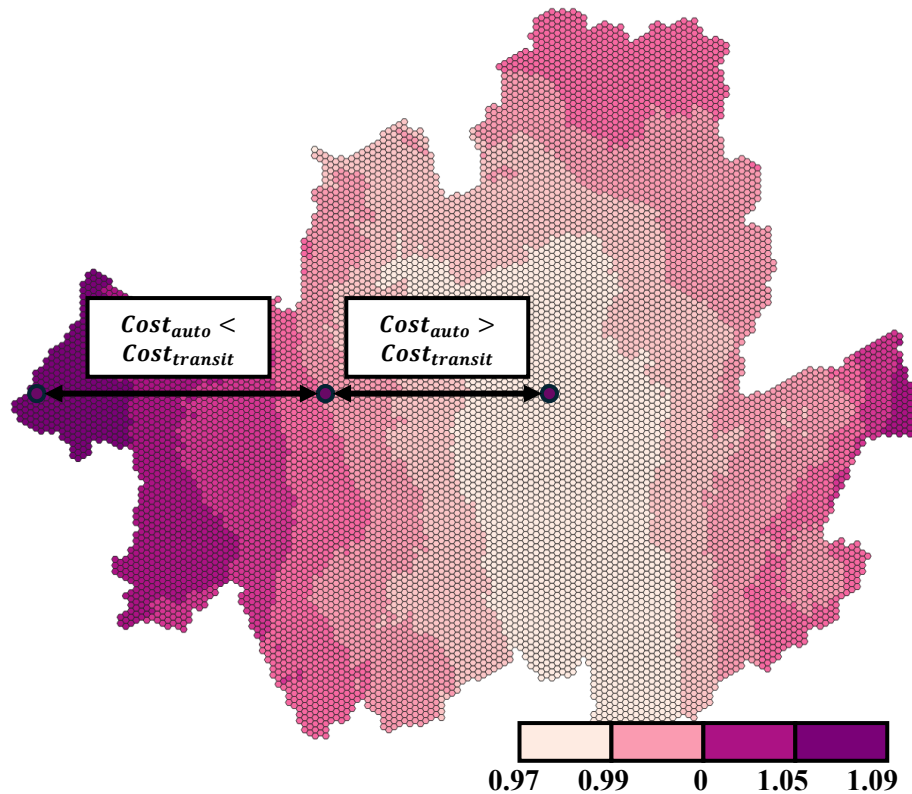


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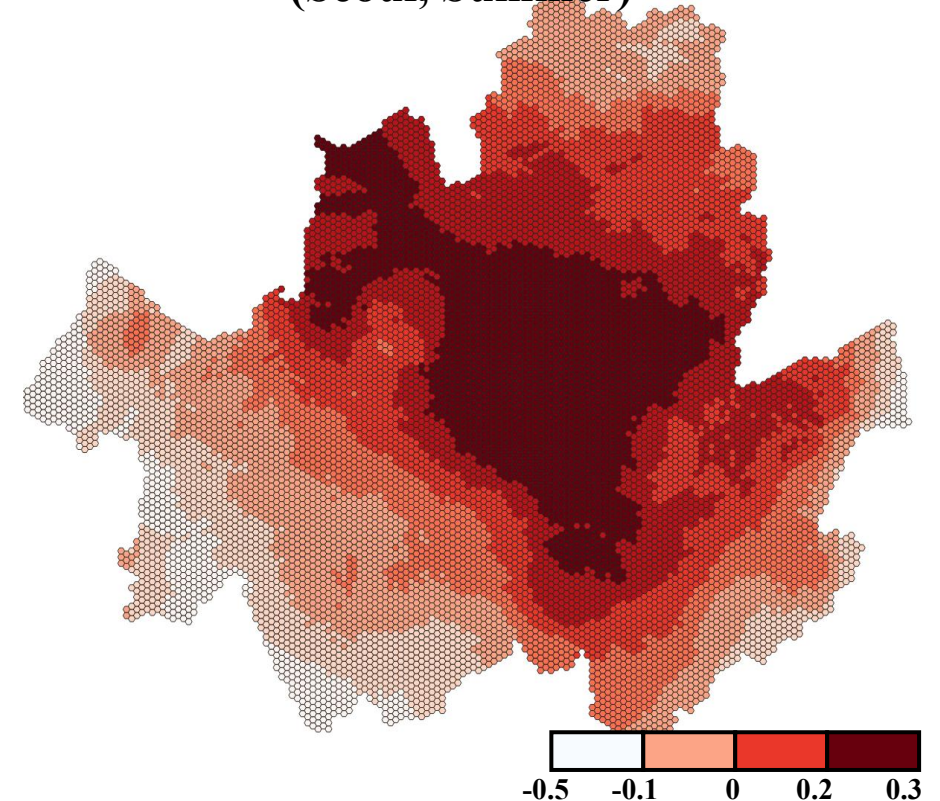
Construction of Multiscale Walkability (3): Macro-Scale Walkability index

- Public transport is relatively more competitive in central Seoul, while private cars are more competitive in peripheral areas.
- Combined with land-use mix and jobs–housing balance, macro-scale walkability forms a strong central-city pattern.

Public Transport / Car Travel Cost Ratio (Seoul)



Distribution of Macro-Scale Walkability (Seoul, Summer)

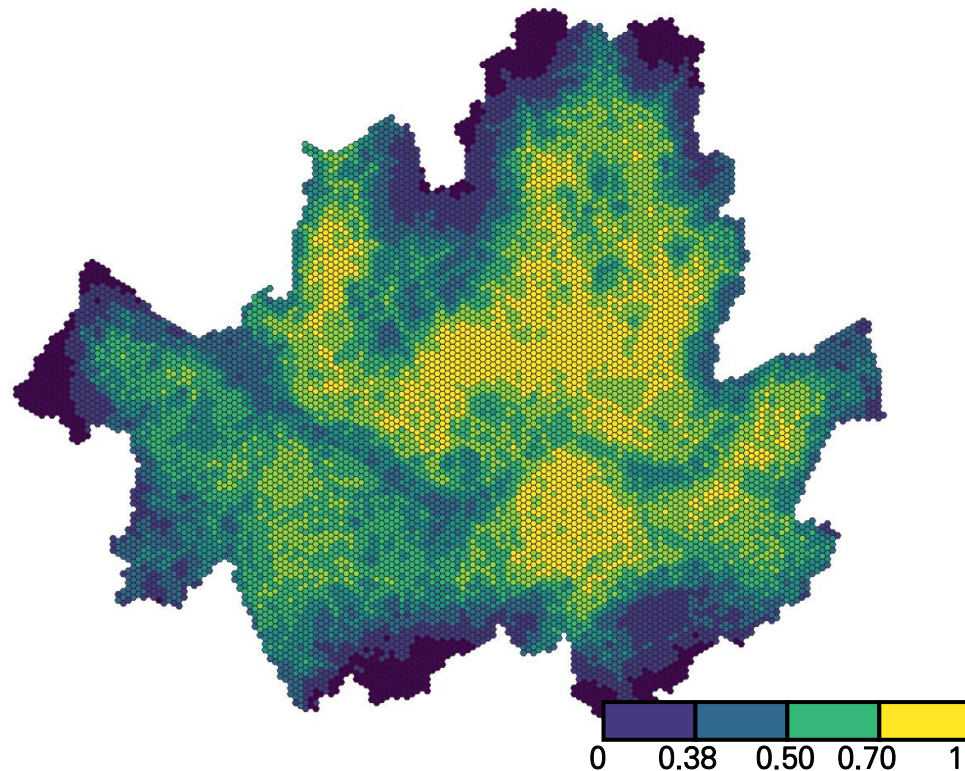


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Construction of Multiscale Walkability (4): Multiscale Walkability measurement

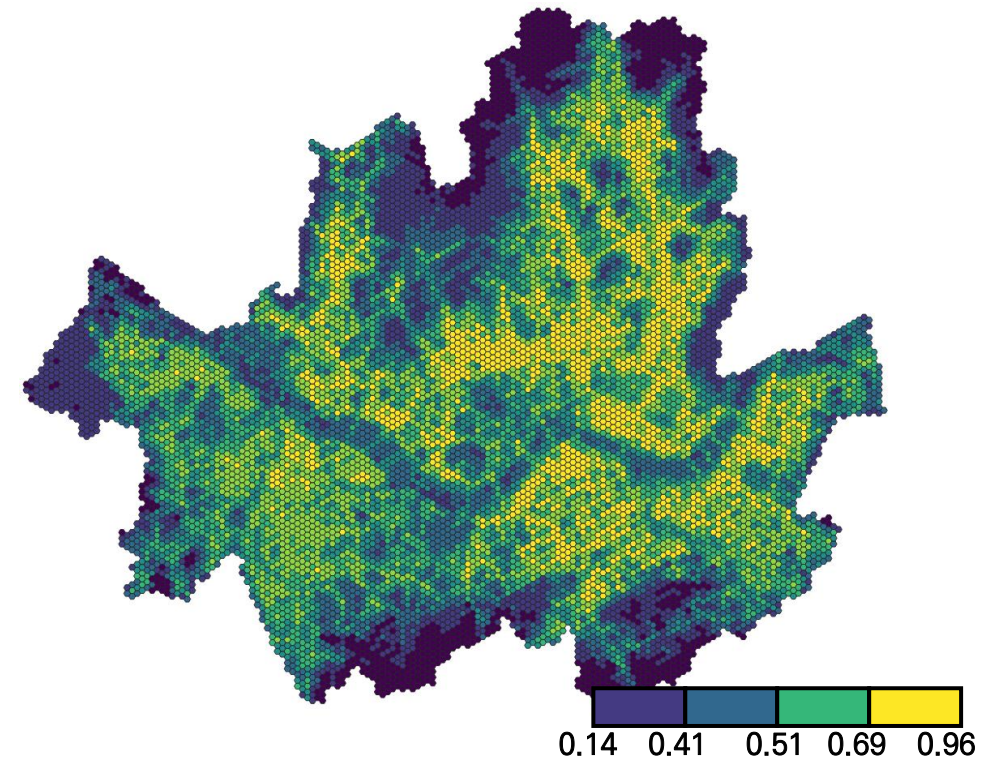
- Multiscale walkability integrates **scale-specific walking environments** to represent urban walkability.
- Two integration approaches were examined: **equal weighting** and **data-driven weighting**.
- Data-driven weighting reveals more distinct spatial variation across Seoul.

멀티스케일 워커빌리티 통합 : 균일 통합방식



멀티스케일 워커빌리티 통합 : 정보량 반영 통합

$$W_{multiscale} = 0.56 * W_{micro} + 0.19 * W_{meso} + 0.25 * W_{macro}$$

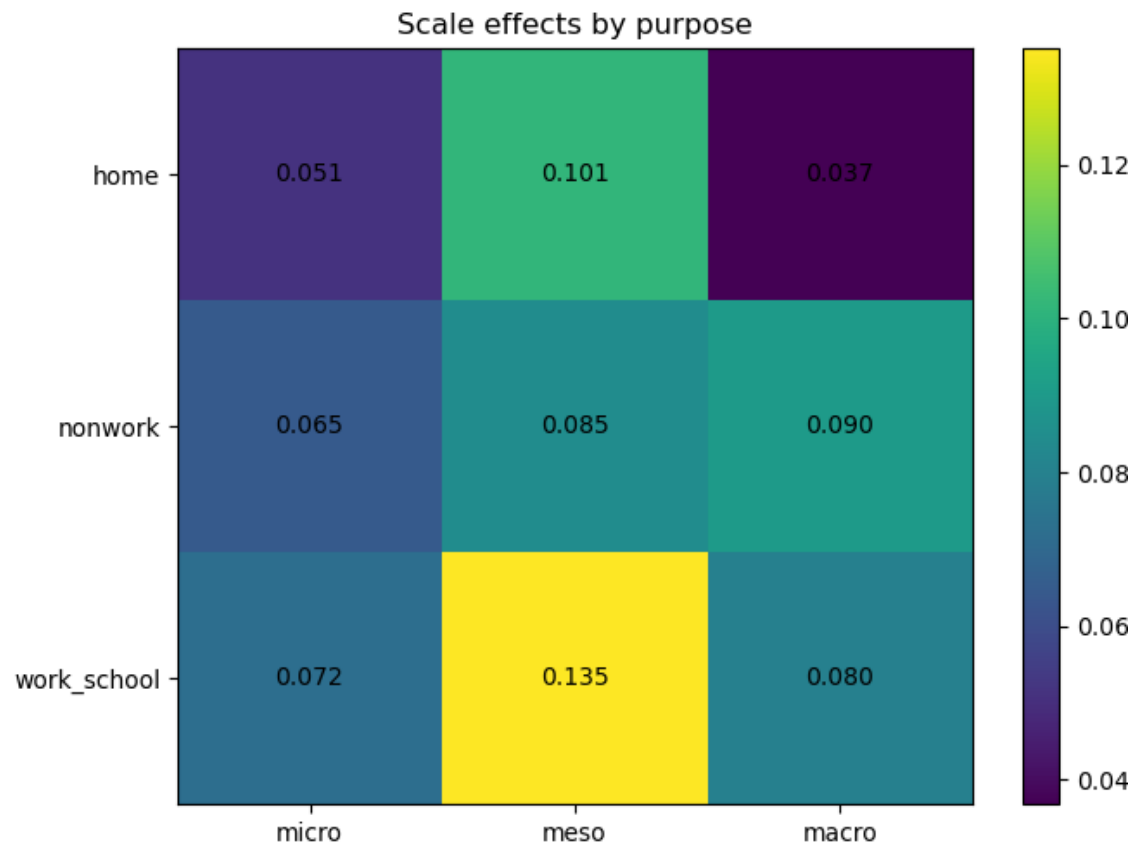


04

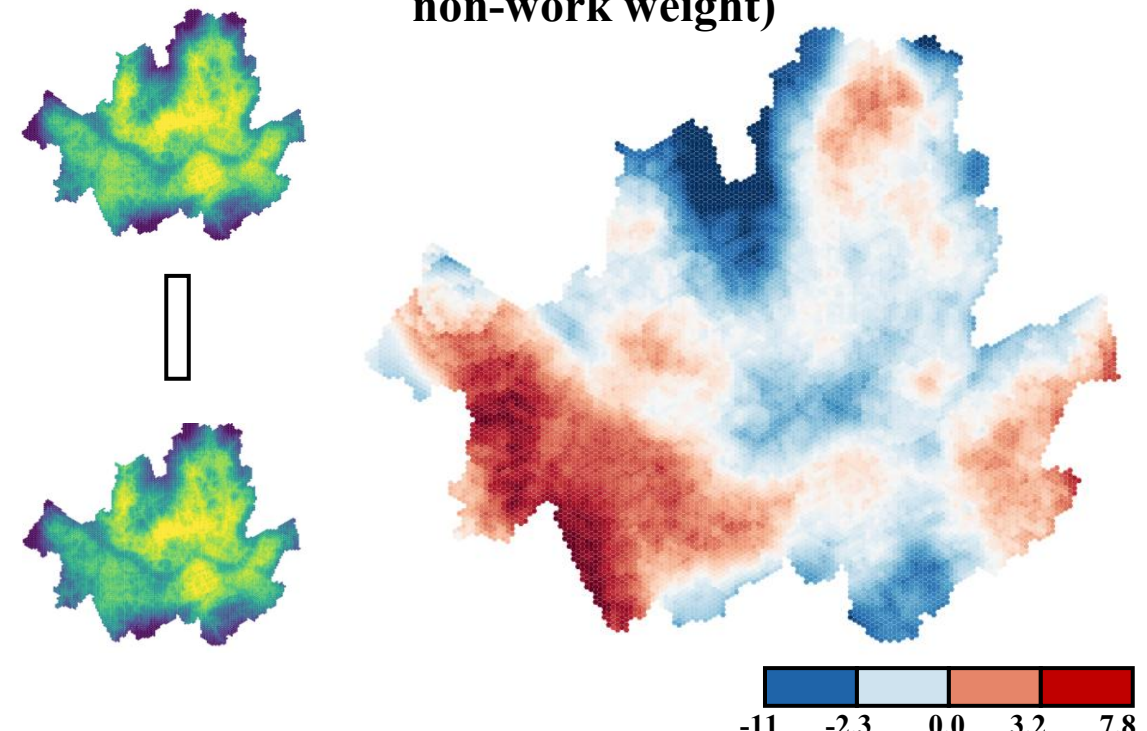
Construction of Multiscale Walkability (5): Coefficient-Based Weighting

- Walking-volume models were estimated **by trip purpose, controlling for population**, and standardized coefficients were used as relative weights.
- Meso-scale walkability received the largest weight, indicating the importance of destination accessibility, public transport, and network connectivity.

Scale-Specific Coefficients by Trip Purpose



**Difference in Weighted Multiscale Walkability:
Commuting vs. Non-Work Trips**
(Red: higher commuting weight / Blue: higher non-work weight)

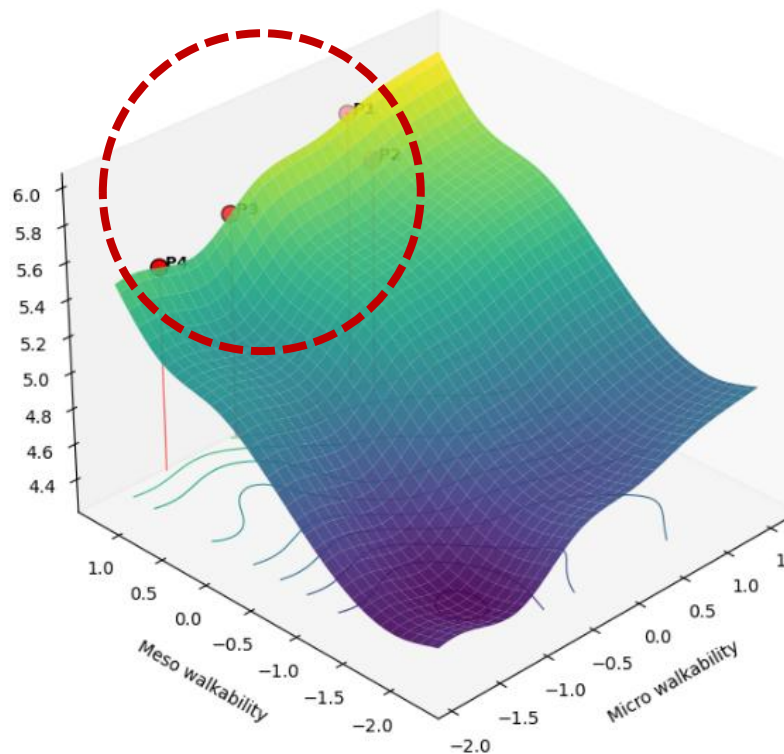


04

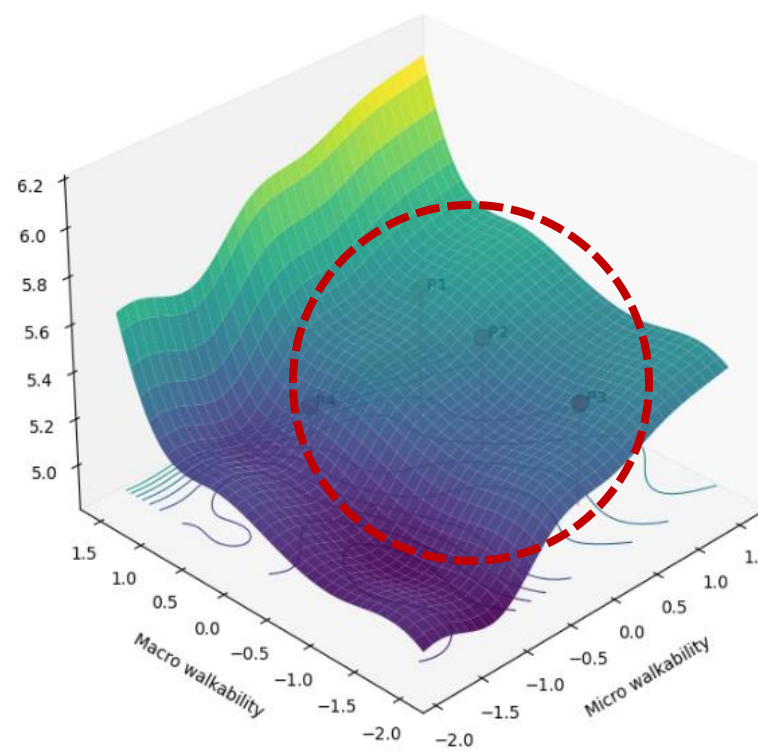
Construction of Multiscale Walkability (6): Complementary Validation Using Walking Volume

- GAM(Generalized Additive Model) was applied to examine nonlinear relationships and threshold effects between scale-specific walkability and walking volume.
- The meso scale showed positive threshold effects, with a marked increase in log walking volume when meso-scale walkability reached approximately 0.946–1.225.

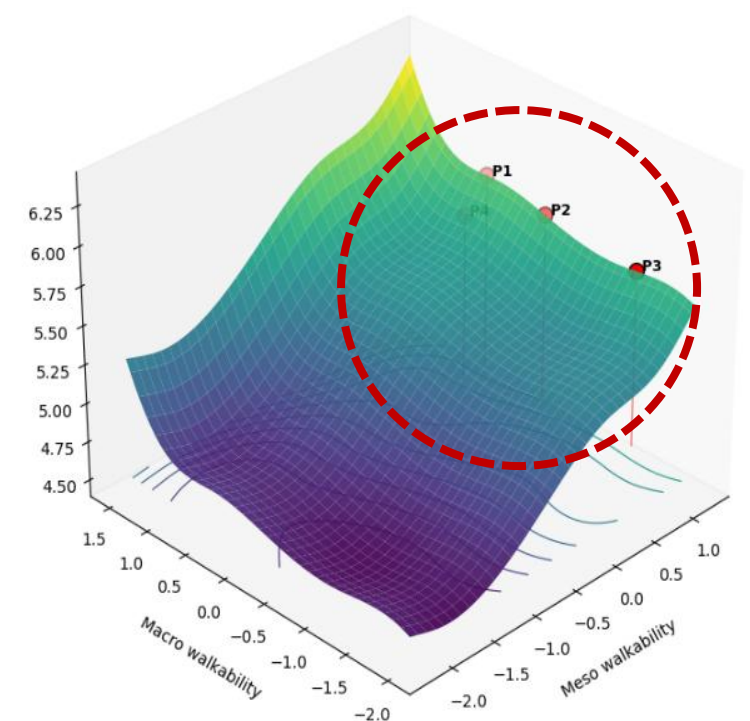
Micro–Meso Response of Walking Volume



Micro–Macro Response of Walking Volume



Meso–Macro Response of Walking Volume



04

Application of Multiscale Walkability: Example of Walking and Accessibility Benefits

- Validated walkability effects can be translated into equivalent walking-time benefits.
- Equivalent time is estimated by comparing walkability coefficients with the walking-time coefficient.
- These values can support interpretation of time savings and accessibility benefits within existing appraisal frameworks.

Example of Equivalent-Time Effects by Trip Purpose

Equivalent-Time(ET) Coefficient

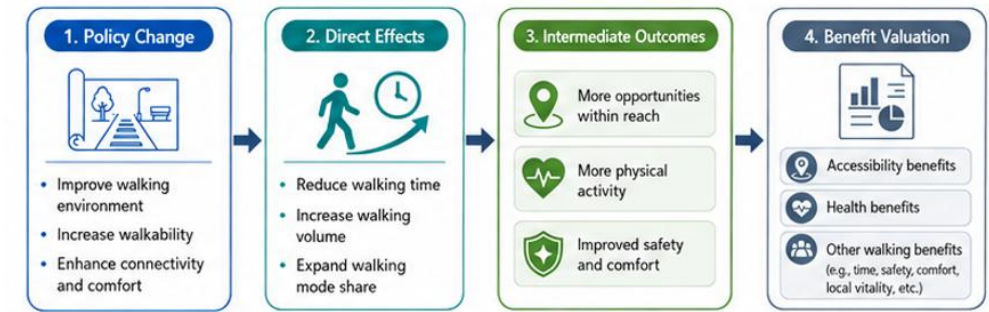
$$\log(1 + walk) = \beta_0 + \beta_{micro} W_{micro} + \beta_{eso} W_{meso} + \beta_{macro} W_{macro} + \beta_p \log(1 + Pop) + \beta_T T_{net}$$

$$ET = \left| \frac{\beta_s}{\beta_t} \right|, s \in \{micro, meso, macro\}$$

Example of Equivalent-Time Coefficient by Trip Purpose

Category		Coefficient	Equivalent Time (min)	Category		Coefficient	Equivalent Time (min)
Comm uting	Micro	0.056	6.55	Non- work	Micro	0.056	3.67
	Meso	0.083	9.68		Meso	0.048	3.22

Example of Benefit Appraisal Framework



Examples of International Appraisal Guidelines

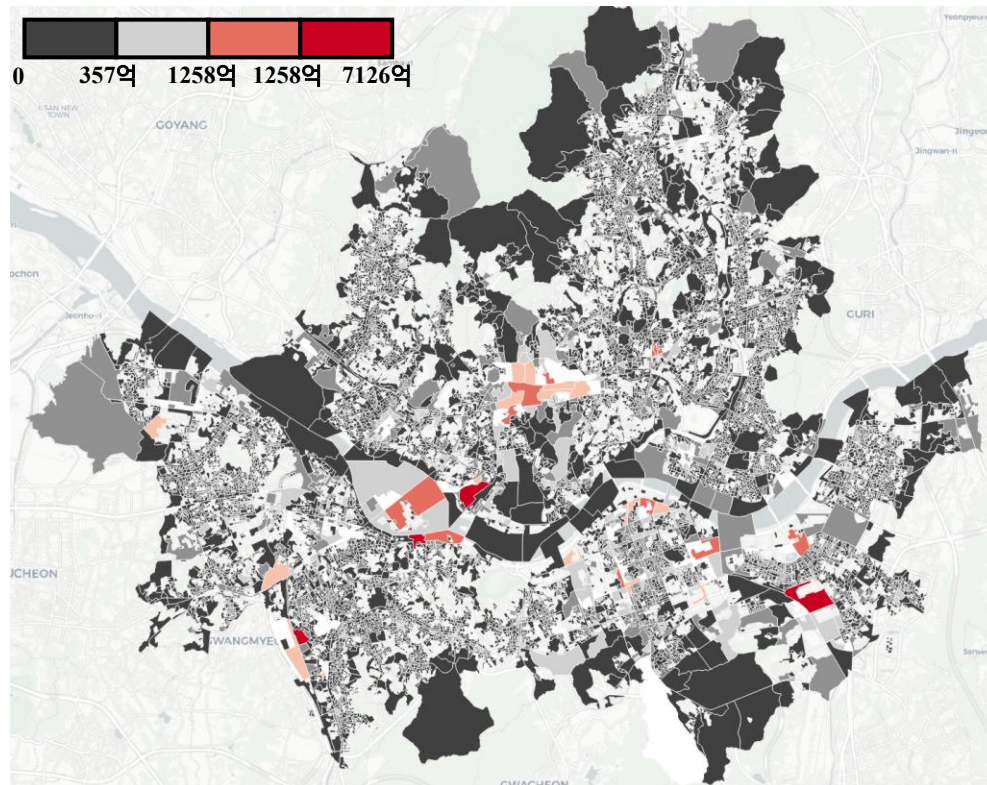
Source	Key Guidance
OECD / ITF	Walking and cycling quality, time value, health benefits
WHO HEAT	Health economic valuation of physical activity
NZ MBCM	Monetised benefits of active transport
OECD/ITF	Transport benefit appraisal framework

04

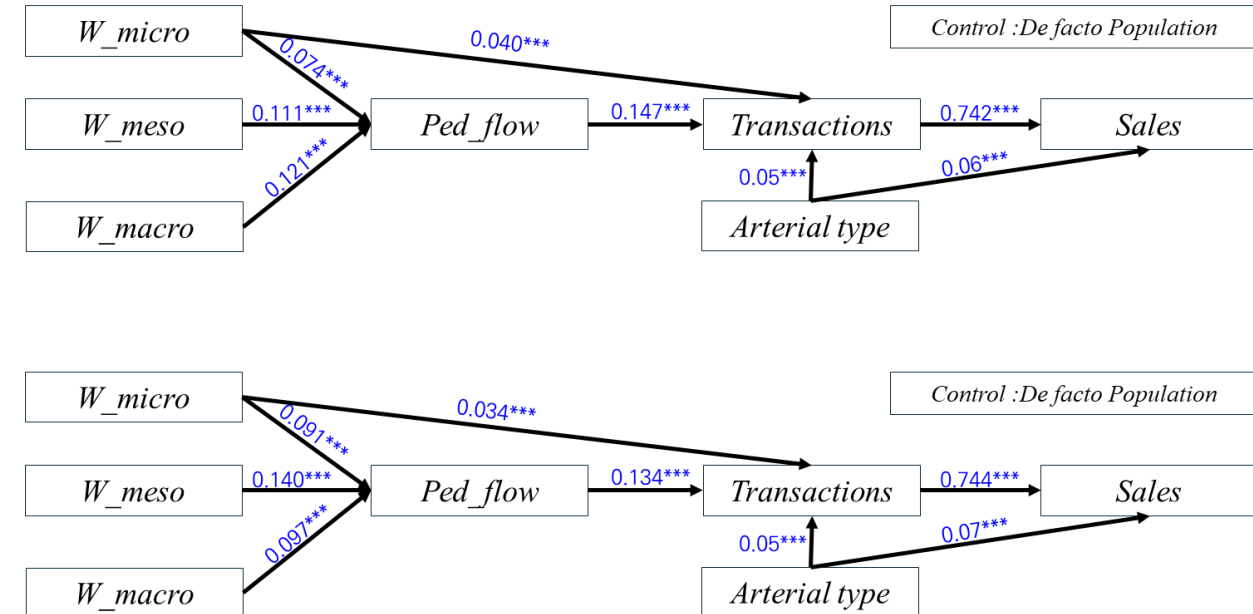
Market Activity Analysis Results (1): Multiscale Walkability and Commercial Activity

- Market activity shows spatial clustering, indicating spatial dependence across commercial areas.
- Structural Equation Modeling (SEM) results show that multiscale walkability is **positively associated with pedestrian flow, which is linked to transactions and sales**.
- Some scales also show **direct relationships with commercial activity**, suggesting both direct and indirect pathways.

**Distribution of Commercial Activity
(Quarterly Sales)**



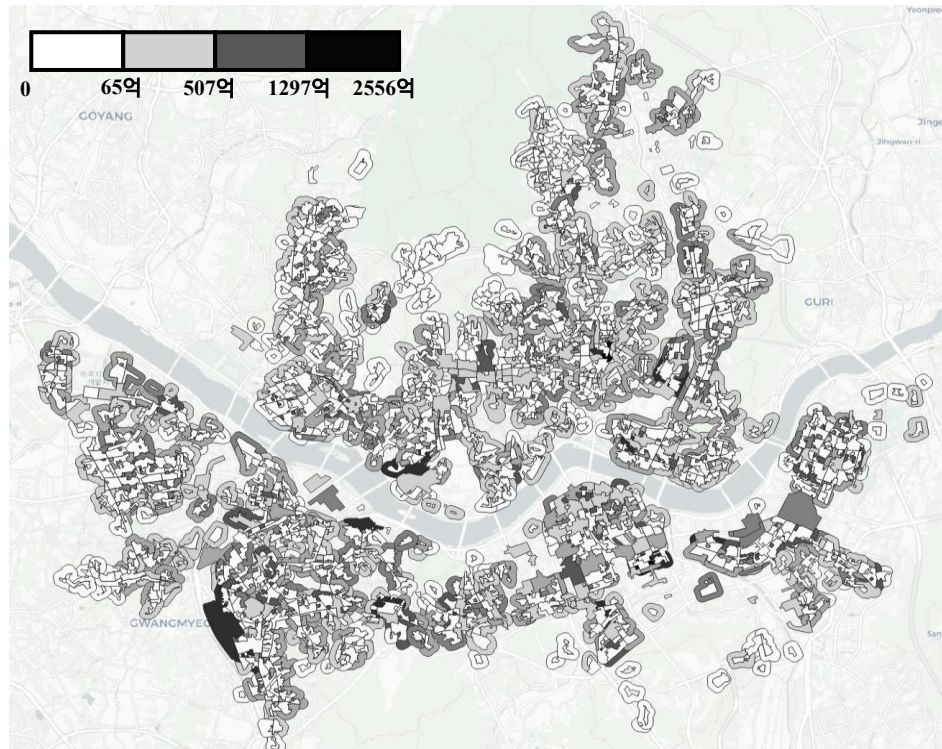
**Structural Equation Modeling (SEM) Results by Season
(Summer vs. Winter)**



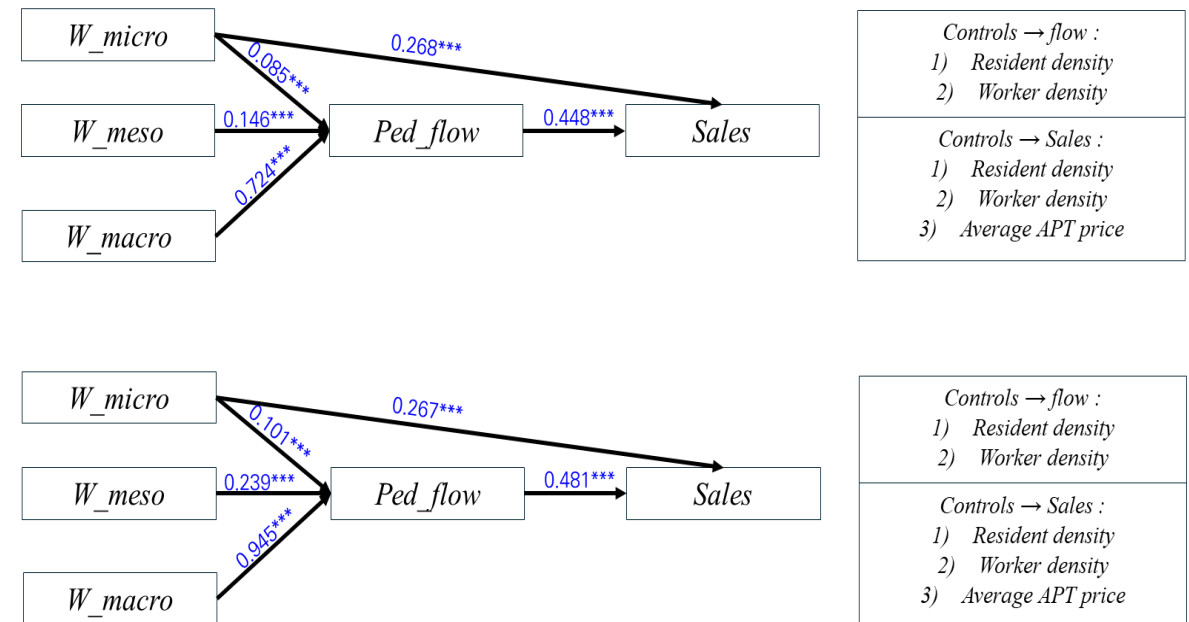
04 Market Activity Analysis Results (2): Commercial-Area-Level Analysis of Multiscale Walkability

- SEM results show that multiscale walkability is **positively associated with pedestrian flow and sales** in both summer and winter.
- Pedestrian flow also shows a strong positive relationship with sales, suggesting an indirect pathway from walkability to market activity.

Distribution of Average Weekday Sales by Commercial Area



Structural Equation Modeling (SEM) Results by Season:
Summer vs. Winter

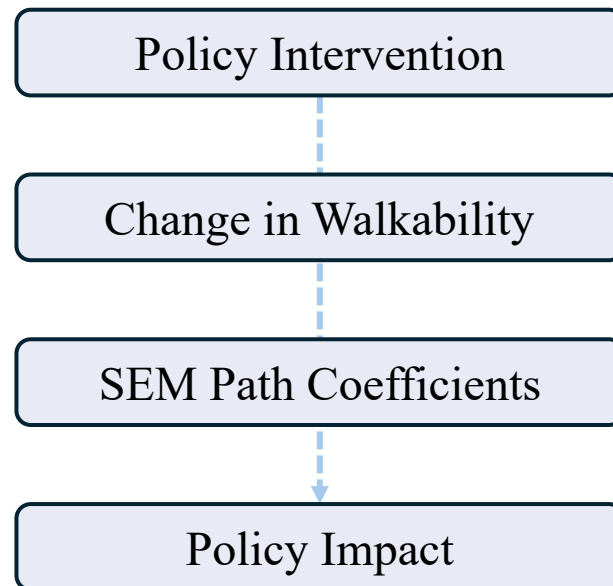


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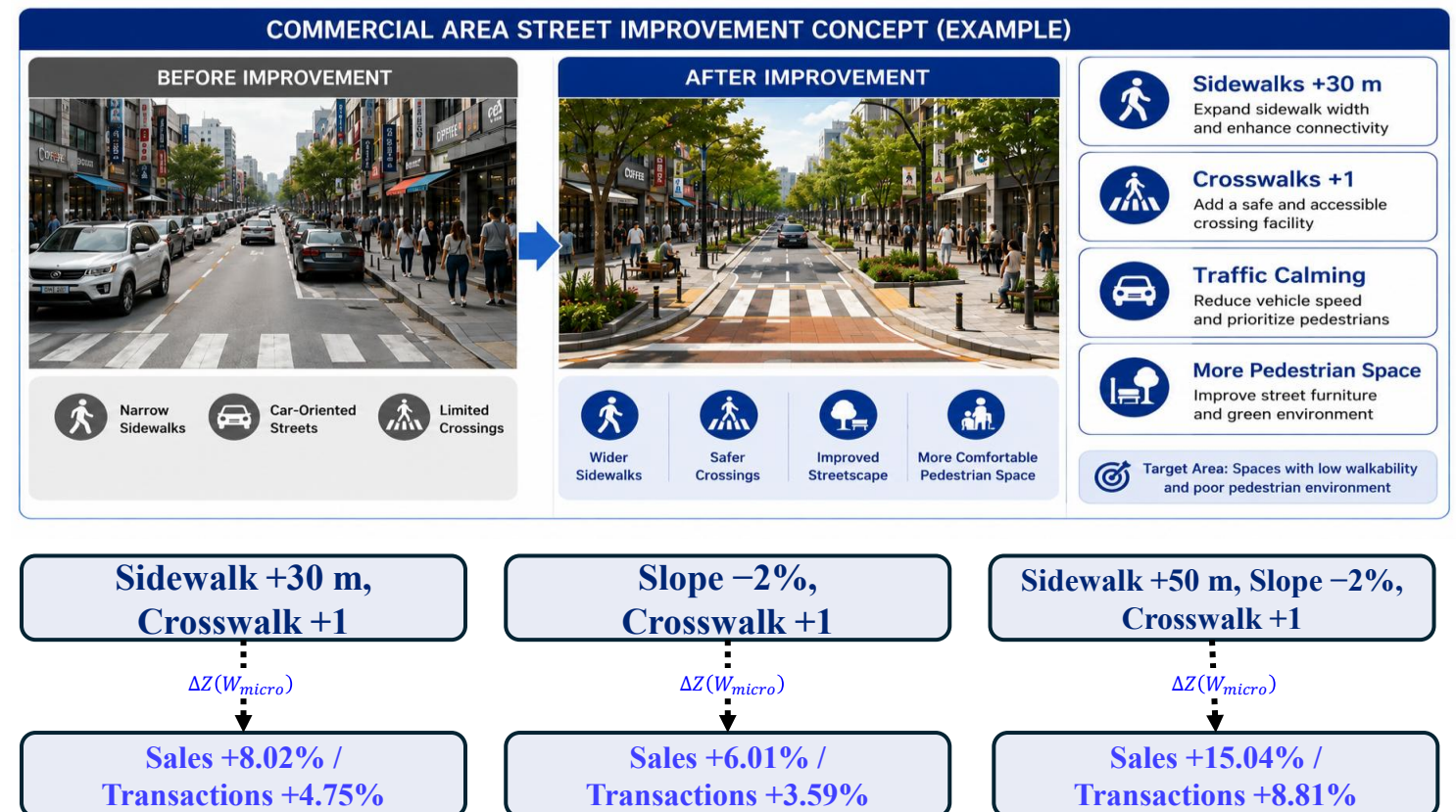
Market Activity Analysis Results (4): Policy Translation of Multiscale Walkability Improvements

- Physical and accessibility improvements were converted into standardized changes in scale-specific walkability indicators and linked to SEM path coefficients.
- For micro-scale scenarios, improvements in **sidewalks, slopes, and crosswalks** were translated into potential changes in sales and transactions.

Common Policy Translation Framework for Multiscale Walkability



Micro-Scale Walkability Improvement Scenarios and Estimated Effects

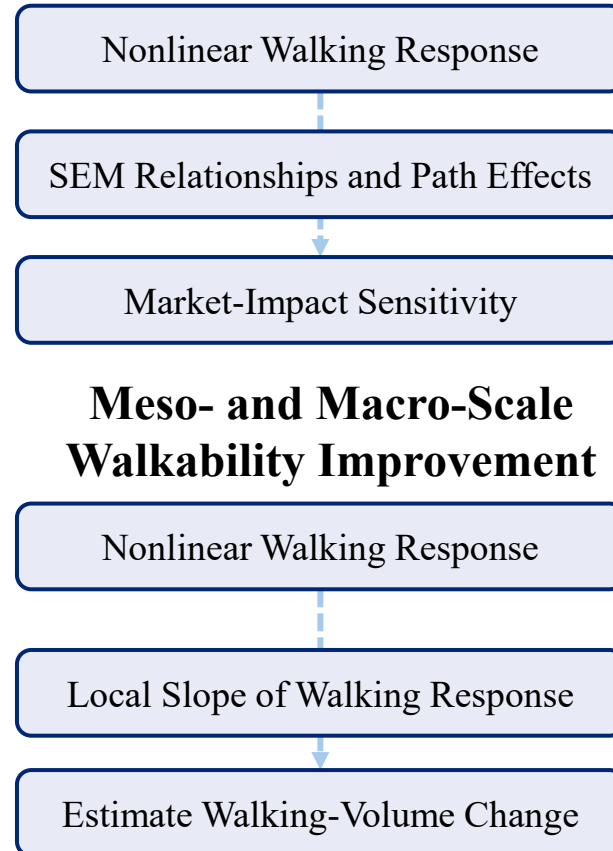
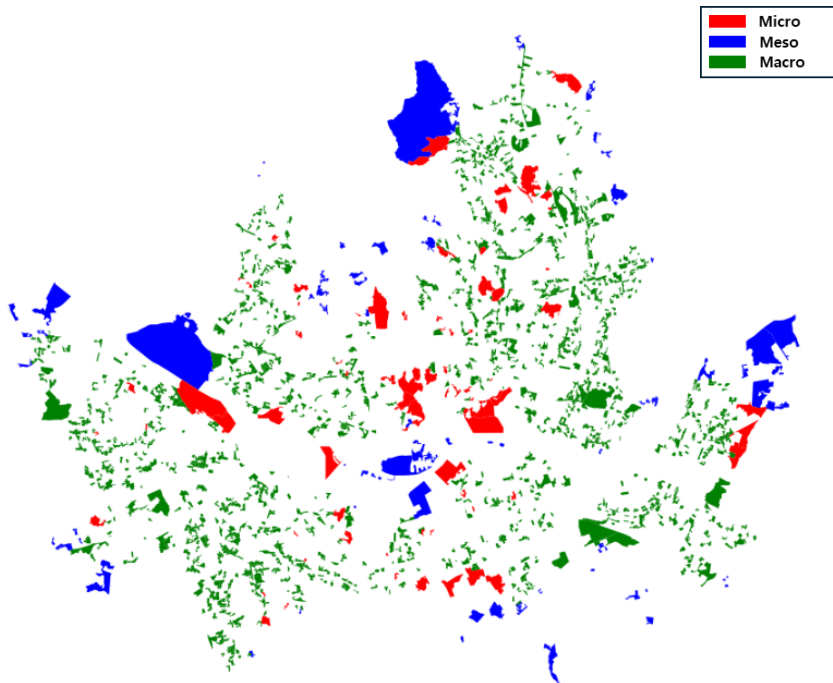


04

Market Activity Analysis Results (4): Policy Translation of Multiscale Walkability Based on Nonlinear Walking Responses

- GAM-based nonlinear walking responses by walkability scale were linked with SEM-based structural relationships between pedestrian flow and sales to examine potential commercial impacts of localized walking-volume responses.

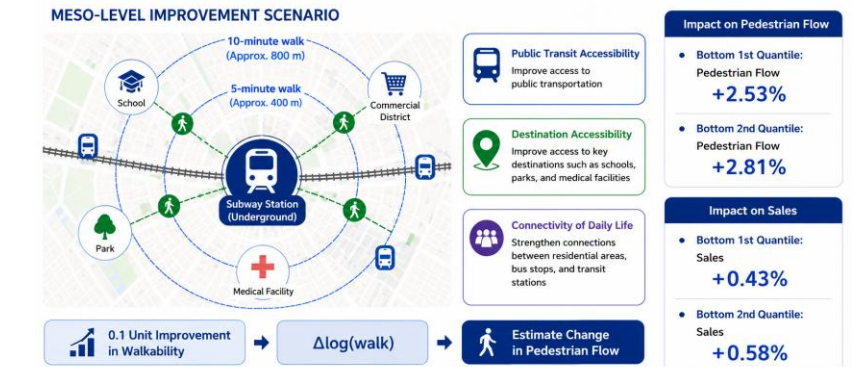
Scale-Specific Vulnerable Areas of Micro-Scale Walkability Improvement Walkability Indicators (Bottom 1–2 Quantiles)



Improvement Scenario and Estimated Effects (Increase W_{micro} by 0.1)



Improvement Scenario and Estimated Effects (Increase W_{meso} and W_{macro} by 0.1)



5. Conclusion

I. Conclusions and Limitations

II. Future Research



05 Conclusions and Future Research

• Conclusions and Limitations

1. Walkability is conceptualized as a **multiscale framework** consisting of micro, meso, and macro dimensions.
2. Multiscale walkability is **structurally linked to market activity**, with different effects across spatial scales.
3. The study identifies pathways from **walkability to pedestrian flow and sales**, and demonstrates potential policy translation of walkability improvements.
4. **However, the analysis is observational, limiting causal interpretation, and spatial heterogeneity may remain.**

• Future Research

1. Expand behavioral data and conduct panel or simulation-based analyses to **evaluate the magnitude and persistence of walkability effects**.
2. Extend multiscale walkability to **mobility planning and multimodal environments**, including emerging mobility systems.
3. Apply the framework to **street redesign and policy evaluation** to support pedestrian-oriented urban planning.



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THANK YOU



Ph.D. Dissertation

Multi-scale Walkability
Measurement Framework :
Application to Market Activity Analysis

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